

Independent Medicare & ACA Agents — Deep Buyer Research

Health Insurance Ecosystem · the independent Medicare, ACA and health insurance agent or broker who buys leads · Researched 2026-09-25 · refresh due 2027-03-25 · Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/health-insurance-agents/research/>

60,249 documents in the shared corpus · 3,137 buyer documents in this page's voice · 356 ads to this audience of 2,890 read.

TLDR

- Who: 3,137 first-person agent documents (3,020 health / general agents, 77 life or final-expense agents talking about buying leads, 40 new or aspiring agents) from r/InsuranceAgent, agent Facebook groups, Insurance-Forums.com and agent YouTube. Property & casualty agents, call-center staff, vendors and recruiters are excluded.
- The lead is the whole job: Previous Solutions is the largest tab (320 documents bought leads from vendors, 86 aged leads, 104 transfers and inbound calls, 68 self-generated), and the top frustration after MLM recruiting is leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer (125 documents).
- What they pay (published prices, median of the vendors' ranges, Medicare Advantage): aged records \$1.00–\$6.50, shared \$15–\$31, exclusive \$35–\$75, T65 \$45–\$90, live transfers / inbound calls \$58–\$109 per call. The Lead Sources tab lists every price agents wrote themselves, with its link.
- What an enrollment is worth, and what each lead type costs to get one: \$725 for a new Medicare Advantage enrollment in 2027 (CMS maximum), \$363 a year after; Medicare Supplement about \$502 in year one; ACA \$20–\$30 per member per month. At published rates one MA enrollment costs the agent \$48–\$312 from aged data, \$233–\$437 from transfers, \$516–\$1,106 from exclusive leads, \$1,820–\$3,059 from Meta lead-form leads and \$1,958–\$3,982 from shared leads (Metrics tab).
- Who sells to them: 356 agent-facing Meta ads — 180 from lead, transfer and call sellers and 89 from agencies and FMOs recruiting agents with leads included. The most-used hooks: name the audience, 'exclusive / verified / compliant', and 'inbound calls, no dialing'.
- The read for Vince (hypothesis): agents don't need more lead sellers; they need leads they trust. At published rates the event that clears the market is a held appointment or transfer produced by calling low-cost data, not a raw Meta form fill; a Meta lead is worth an exclusive price only if its contact and set rates match exclusive leads, so measure the first leads before pricing. Consent to one agent, a verified phone and a written replacement policy answer the top complaint directly.

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Tab 1 — Fears

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Not making enough to stay in the business · 39 documents

"If it's low stress and you're making that level of money, please stay. I'm a director of a commercial lines division making a little more than that and when I tell you that it is exhausting and a nonstop grind."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rft8td/13_years_in_140kyr_need_advice/o7mlq53/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

Money spent on leads that don't pay back · 23 documents

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps 😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

Being tied to an agency, upline or contract · 16 documents

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

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"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications.
3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an *intent to transfer*. After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The *intent to transfer* process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo>) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"PDP's barely paid much to begin with, it's honestly not that big of a deal. Also, MOST of the non commissioned MAPD's are made that way because carriers are either about to sunset them anyway or they actively don't want you to sell that plan. Until a carrier makes their premier plan non commissioned, I wouldnt worry. My book is doing just fine"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msu3ukc/

Compliance, consent and losing contracts · 7 documents

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

Chargebacks after the enrollment season · 5 documents

"My worst client's renewal is next week. His stuff is all on surplus lines, so he need w short apps for updating exposures etc completed annually. I actually prefill as much as I can (usually the insurance side+ limits etc) and I start sending it to him January. I send every other week until one month out, then it's weekly with a phone call too. I get his receptionist (wife) on maybe half of my calls and he's always busy and she'll take a message. She is literally always confused who I am. Typically the carrier breaks down and offers quotes based off expiring with our the apps which only reinforces his shitty behavior. This year they didn't. I was able to convince them to quite, but they are going to do an audit and inspection after renewal or cancel his ass. They also raised rates. All good imo, we kind of want this guy to go because he's such a PITA. I sent it all and with invoices Friday afternoon. We'll see how it goes lol hopefully he non complies and cancels and we can rod ourselves of it. I don't understand all of the thinking behind it, but my agency owner is worried about an E&O claim if we dont at least get renewal quotes for him, bit of he cancels for non pay or non compliance,we are good and can just tell him to go find a other broker."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sefo1v/ff_insureds_could_just_open_their_mail_and_return/ofju8mq/

"I completely understand your point and I think agents should definitely put more energy towards not being too over leveraged in one market or the other like only ACA or only Medicare. I'm a pretty new agent so I don't have the experience of being a part of the first OEP but what draws me to ACA is honestly just a few key things. I don't want to deal with chargebacks, I want to target a bigger client pool, and honestly I think the quality of agents in my area is pretty low and by focusing on being the best agent I can be I'll naturally rise to the top. I understand that all ACA agents are one major regulatory change away from being in a really bad place and honestly I have no real argument against. I definitely plan on expanding into Medicare eventually but for now, as I am a pretty new to the industry, I want to focus primarily on ACA until I'm more comfortable and confident in my role as an agent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n423dik/

"I wrote 84 apps but it was my first AEP I am worried about charge backs and how much it all equals out to be come Jan 1st. How many did you do in renewals?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nszamaq/

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Theme	Documents
Leads that answer and a phone that rings	68
A book of business and renewals that pay every year	24
Six figures and the freedom that comes with it	14

Leads that answer and a phone that rings · 68 documents

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my as off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mh1vhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

A book of business and renewals that pay every year · 24 documents

"Having done Medicare, I'd do ACA. Your odds are high that you will write the entire family versus Medicare where it's mostly one person. While you can sometimes do husband and wife enrollments it's very rare. Your goal is to build residual income. Plus, no longer dealing with pain the butt elderly people with a 2 minute attention span wanting \$5k/month in food cards who change policies multiple times per year is a bonus. I'm thankful for the experience in Medicare because it really does teach you to overcome objections and pivot pitch. Beyond that, I would never want to sell it again."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kmjoeq/whats_better_aca_or_medicare_sales/msbxbwrl/

"For me it's, \$611 up front for MAPD and \$306 renewals in January. Med Supp Im about \$550 when you factor in PDP. My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare. Add in annuities, FE, CHAS, etc. Being rich depends on the person."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 5 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991>

"Picking apart this story, I have a few things I want to point out: 1) Do as much research as possible into whoever you're going to interview with. Glassdoor, customer reviews, news articles that may or may not feature the company, etc. If you have to pay for your own leads, but only from company approved sources, stay away. Either they let you build your book your way or they provide you leads to work. 2) Never. Ever. Trust the "can make up to \$x/mo" line. What some of these companies do is hire anyone who comes in, milk the bottom tier until they leave, and promote up people who either pull deals out of thin air OR are really good at recruiting. The recruiter can probably make \$10k/mo by bringing in people to buy leads, like they did you. If some policies get written in the process, all the better. 3) If you know it's a Pyramid scheme, why even take the job? 4) Ask important questions during the interview, such as if the job is 1099 or W2. Where do the leads come from? What am I financially responsible for? Do you have any affiliations with major carriers? If it's 1099 and you're responsible for purchasing leads, do you have the freedom to purchase from where you'd like or are you restricted to those same old "approved provider" sources? My personal favorite thing to do is whenever I'm asked about a previous work story of any kind, I try to use something shady I've witnessed to get their reaction. My go to is a guy who took \$6k from an old woman who was still receiving notices from her recently passed son's tax debts. One phone call and a faxed death certificate fixed the whole problem, and this dude was proud of fleecing the old lady. If they get excited about that sort of mentality, don't go with them. Pursue agencies that balances sales volume with professional integrity, rather than closing as many deals as possible and hoping at least 50% make it to a yearly renewal, if that. 5) You will not find one industry that doesn't have cockroaches giving a bad name to the rest. My parents don't trust flooring installers they don't know personally, because they last time they hired someone to re-floor their kitchen and dining room, \$500 of jewelry mysteriously disappeared. 6) From my own experience, if you apply and get invited to an "informational meeting where we break down what we do and how before you decide to go to the next phase of the hiring process", view it as a massive red flag. Having a "short meeting to get to know each other and see if we can do business together" is fine, if not unconventional, but informational lectures as the first stage of hiring just screams "sketchy". Best of luck in whatever direction you'd go in, but I'd recommend maintaining your license and fulfilling your state requirements to keep it. Can always come in handy, no matter what you do. I let mine lapse after a rough gig and it's been a headache to get back now that I'm my current employer."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lc9vldd/

Six figures and the freedom that comes with it · 14 documents

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Theme	Documents
Friends and family pressure (the warm market)	46
Clients who get angry when they are called	22
A spouse and household riding on commission income	21
Uplines, managers and recruiters	16

Friends and family pressure (the warm market) · 46 documents

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

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"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

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"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

Clients who get angry when they are called · 22 documents

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

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"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAq

↳ @thomasmorris2245 (6): "Congratulations on your first sale"

↳ @15pluna (4): "hey quick question do you mean the leads are 5-10 yrs old???? impressiiveeee!"

↳ @oExlusive (0): "@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

A spouse and household riding on commission income · 21 documents

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But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

"This is what sets us (DigitalBGA) apart from other telesales FE Agencies: - Our contracts are direct with the carriers and have earned custom telesales signature options to make transacting final expense over the phone easier for seniors. - We produce and run our own TV commercials, web call ins and internet leads. We see the sales results in real time and cut the losers and scale the winners. - We've built our own technology agents leverage to simplify receiving calls/working leads and having your KPI's at your fingertips to see where you need the most improvement. - We have a team of "A" players supporting and coaching agents every day. Our agent partners support each other daily as well. - We've been committed to telesales and nothing else since our inception in 2016. If you want to meet and ask a bunch of DigitalBGA agents questions, join this Facebook group as 99% of our agent partners don't frequent this forum and there's many in there."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444491>

Uplines, managers and recruiters · 16 documents

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to aflack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"I watched the FX vid that was posted here and he talked about a rogue agent writing 40k of bad business and fleeing the country. My Assurant regional manager told me a better one. Assurant came out with a feature where if an app was instantly approved - meaning the second you submitted the app it was approved without any UW, you got 12 months advanced commission. What could go wrong? A new agent signed up his entire network of friends. They chose the most expensive plans, listed zero health conditions and all were auto-approved, earning him \$48,000 in commissions. His friends all then cancelled the policies during the 10 day free look. His MGA apparently didn't think it was a flag that a new agent wrote that much in two weeks. Every dime was charged back to the MGA who had to file BK over it and the agent went off to Mexico."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1b228y/

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

Theme	Documents
'Don't buy leads, generate your own'	15
'The money is in the renewals / your book'	15

'Don't buy leads, generate your own' · 15 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . Id say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

↳ @MyPowerfulClips (4): "Where are you working where you don't pay for leads ?!"

↳ @patinamia (4): "how do you find clients without buying leads"

↳ @Lovebeyondfear1111 (0): "This is awesomeness !! Where do you see your career in the long run?"

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p9t9/badaleads_scam/

'The money is in the renewals / your book' · 15 documents

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoRQzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAg>

↳ @davidcampo2902 (13): "Everything you said is spot on! I I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

↳ @roberthoeller5516 (5): "I too sell both and agree with you 110%."

↳ @rodbutler4054 (4): "Spoken like a true insurance salesman!"

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

"Yes, but years 1 & 2 are solid working years (build a base for renewals) in health expect about 40-60k in new business, (money to you). This is health insurance, my niche is Medicare and I love it. By year 5 you should be somewhere near 200k annually (gross) with renewals and new clients. Oh, and I don't really work that hard, if I did my numbers would be double..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc6m3ct/

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Theme	Documents
MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises	156
Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer	125
CMS rules, commission caps and carrier cuts	74
Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies)	32
Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers	17
Dialing all day for a handful of conversations	8

MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises · 156 documents

"Recently accepted a job with Globe Life Hi, I'm working on getting my life/health License. I just got accepted to sell insurance for American Income Life, a subsidiary of Globe Life. Has anyone done this and can let me know if this is the right move to start my insurance journey? I'll be selling life insurance to union workers and they said all my leads are from the workers filling out their info so they should be waiting for a call so seems like an easy sell. I'd love some insight to anyone that knows what I'm getting into or has first hand experience working with this company. Update: I accepted the job but next day I called and cancelled. Never spent a day working for Globe Life."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 114 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer · 125 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2Caps%2C266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: I Industry I Description I I --- I --- I Tech I You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. I Med I You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. I Finance/Insurance I You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. I Hardware/Construction I Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. I Cars I You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. I Door to Door I Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. I JOB TITLE I PAY RANGE (Salary) I PAY RANGE (OTE) I DESCRIPTION** I I --- I --- I --- I SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) I £25,000 - £40,000 I £50,000 - £80,000 I Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. I SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive I £30,000 - £60,000 I £50,000 - £140,000 I Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. I MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive I £40,000 - £75,000 I £60,000 - £150,000 I Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. I ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive I £50,000 - £100,000 I £70,000 - £250,000 I Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. I SALES MANAGER I £60,000 - £120,000 I £80,000 - £200,000 I Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. I MD: Managing Director I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. I HEAD OF SALES I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. I Terminology I Description I I --- I --- I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. I Lead I This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. I Account I This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. I Contact I This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. I Example of a lead, a contact and an account. I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

CMS rules, commission caps and carrier cuts · 74 documents

"Let's remember what selling health was like pre-ACA Before 2010, I was running a rather large individual health insurance agency. Jan 2010 literally put me out of business overnight as commissions evaporated. I looked at my wife and said "well, this all needed to change." Commission rocked. 25% average on the front, 5% renewals on average. \$400/mo premium = \$1,200. Market was everyone that didn't have group. We could even pull people off group. Although highly unethical, it happened all the time. 1. Declines for all major health conditions. Diabetes? Decline. Heart? Decline. 2. Ratings or waivers/riders for every other health condition you can imagine. HBP, Asthma, etc...rated 25% to 50% or the condition was excluded from coverage. Some more mild conditions might have only resulted in a drug waiver. 3. Post claims underwriting. No carrier pulled medical records or MIB reports. Instead, they waited until they filed a claim. Any misrepresentation on the app resulted in either a denial of that claim or a policy rescission. For auto, imagine no one checked anything; no DMV report, didn't run their license and only did that when they went to file a claim, then cancelled the policy. 4. Fraud was everywhere. Agents knew they wouldn't get paid for putting conditions/meds on the app, so they excluded them. I was trained by Mega Life to never list health conditions. Tough conversations with newly self-employed people. Many simply could not get covered. People who had direct control over their health, like smokers I had little sympathy for. People with conditions out of their control? Horrible phone calls."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are *a ton* of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill".** From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects "yet"? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies) · 32 documents

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"What in the actual fuck is happening in this industry. (ACA) Overused milked leads, marketplace looking like a brothel, people being promised subsidy cards, free grocery cards, nothing short than being promised a free Mercedes-Benz which I'm sure someone has been already promised. That being said, a great company I'm with, but holy cow man, what an actual cess-pool of agents just circle jerking each other with ol miss Emmy Lou in Lagrange, Mississippi's market-place profile. Luckily I have a 80% closing ratio on getting them to lock me down as their agent for 365. I love it"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j5cd0q/what_in_the_actual_fuck_is_happening_in_this/

Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers · 17 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Have you ever considered, you know, actually generating your own leads with community engagement in a niche market? Seriously... It works. I have done it for nine years. Wouldn't even know where to get a lead that was purchased if I tried. Also, thank God this is happening. The number of spam calls I get per day is ungodly and they interrupt my actual calls from call waiting. It's horrible. I hope all the overseas scammers shrivel up and go back to the holes they came from. I am tired of trying to tell my mom that I did not go to Mexico and will never be kidnapped there, she does not have a tax debt, and her Amazon order doesn't exist. Most of the time she is fine, and sends me an 'lol you are not in Mexico getting robbed are you?' text. But I know the day is coming when that fails and I will be very grateful if it comes after this happens."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/mx7qq7x/

Dialing all day for a handful of conversations · 8 documents

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Theme	Documents
Bought leads from vendors	320
Cold calling, door knocking and seminars	211
Referrals and their own book	208
Captive or call-center job first	204
FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs	106
Live transfers and inbound calls	104
Aged leads	86
Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing)	68

Bought leads from vendors · 320 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

Cold calling, door knocking and seminars · 211 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C%266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

Referrals and their own book · 208 documents

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoRQzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq>

↳ @davidcampo2902 (13): "Everything you said is spot on! I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

↳ @roberthoeller5516 (5): "I too sell both and agree with you 110%."

↳ @rodbutler4054 (4): "Spoken like a true insurance salesman!"

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... 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It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

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"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

Captive or call-center job first · 204 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHQAIVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&prefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in "The Pursuit of Happiness". | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Insurance sales is a joke, right? Former insurance salesman here(notice that it doesn't say agent) and after having several sales roles with varying commission structures consistently the worst ones were always the insurance roles besides working for a moving company. Having to pay for my licenses, taking 20-60 hours of coursework, having to deal with some of the worst pools of leads I've had to work with from people who don't even know who you are, to having to try to sell a 500\$ monthly premium to the couple paying a fourth of that through a local farm bureau. It just never, ever felt rewarding. The icing on the shit-cake being that you never even saw a lick of commission until you reach a certain threshold. Even the other shitty companies would let you have a crumb of the pie, but insurance tends to fall on the "salary" model so that while your base is higher than most, you better get used to that base. I've gotten good training in my career from jobs like this, but unless it's a me issue how the hell has anyone survived there longterm besides outlasting and inheriting books of business? I work in the dealership side of things now and do not regret it a sliver. edit:

"clarification"

— r/sales · 202 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1wknc2g/insurance_sales_is_a_joke_right/

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to *retain* a book to getting paid to *write new business*. They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs · 106 documents

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— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

Live transfers and inbound calls · 104 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5-2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Had my first sale today! I'm a new agent in Florida, independent. All inbound leads. Today was my first day on my own after training. Just super excited n I needed to put it out there!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

Aged leads · 86 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeee/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAq

↳ @thomasmorris2245 (6): "Congratulations on your first sale"

↳ @15pluna (4): "hey quick question do you mean the leads are 5-10 yrs old???? impressiiveeee!"

↳ @oExlusive (0): "@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing) · 68 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Solution Soundbites is small: agents talk in problems and vendor names more than in wishes; the wishes that exist are about trustworthy leads and a better FMO.

Theme	Documents
Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers	12
Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job	9
Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented	8

Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers · 12 documents

"Independent agent looking for IMO with no requirements — just carrier access Independent agent here. I run my own leads and dialer and don't need training or a system. Looking for a true hands-off IMO/FMO that offers: \- Street-level comp \- No required meetings or Zoom \- No CRM fees \- Full contract ownership Just want carrier access and to be left alone to produce. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_with_no/

"I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training. I'm currently with an IMO but not a fan of the environment. I want honest sales and reliable income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/

"I'm primarily looking for a FMO that will send me a birthday card."

— Insurance-Forums.com · What is important to you in selecting an upline FMO? · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/what-is-important-to-you-in-selecting-an-upline-fmo.94948/#post-1259111>

Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job · 9 documents

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented · 8 documents

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
Six figures, or the month it finally worked	55
A book of business paying renewals	14
Inbound business: clients who call them	6

Six figures, or the month it finally worked · 55 documents

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This led to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Finally got my dream job!! I don't know if anyone else is in Alabama but I finally found an agency where I don't have to buy a single lead and I can bring in consistent income, they have a nice office in Vestavia and they offered to pay for my licensing too though I already had mine! Really excited to see what the future holds, I also made my biggest check last week!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qxr5nv/finally_got_my_dream_job/

A book of business paying renewals · 14 documents

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

"Can I Sell Obamacare Independently & Keep Full Commissions? (San Antonio, TX) I recently found out that independent agents can sell ACA (Obamacare) plans and get paid per enrollee. I have an unusual connection to a ton of lower-income people who don't have health insurance, and if the plans are free for them, I don't see why they wouldn't take it. I have some questions before I jump in: 1. Can I work 100% for myself and keep the full residual commissions? 2. Do all ACA plans pay commissions, or do some \$0 plans not pay anything? 3. What's the standard commission per enrollee in Texas? I've heard numbers between \$10-\$20 per month per person, but I need confirmation. 4. If I go independent, can I start right away and get full commissions, or do I need to be under a broker at first? 5. How long does it take to get licensed and start enrolling people? I'm based in San Antonio, TX, and I know a ton of uninsured people who would easily sign up if I could get them covered for free. If this is real and scalable, I'm willing to grind hard and build this into a full-time business. If anyone has real experience selling ACA plans independently, please let me know what I'm missing. I don't want to waste time if there's a catch I haven't seen yet. Thanks in advance! Oh PS: My sister in mesa AZ wants to do the same thing. She manages a huge trailer park with residents."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8i38s/can_i_sell_obamacare_independently_keep_full/

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

Inbound business: clients who call them · 6 documents

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/6l3fuc/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internet.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trusted lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"It's great to see your enthusiasm for the real estate industry! The collaborative nature of this field really does open up so many opportunities, not just for personal growth but also for building a strong network that can lead to more successful transactions. Connecting with mortgage lenders and other service providers can create a seamless experience for clients, which is invaluable. I completely agree that the benefits are endless, especially when you leverage those relationships effectively. Staying engaged with your network and being proactive in seeking out collaborations can really set you apart. Full disclosure: I'm the founder of Rereerrals.com, a SaaS that can help you in this because it streamlines the process of connecting with other agents and enhances your ability to close deals through referrals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iqsrez/love_this_industry/md31pcu/

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Theme	Documents
Dialing and the phone, all day	91

Service work: renewals, changes, client problems	35
AEP and enrollment season hours	6

Dialing and the phone, all day · 91 documents

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeee/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

Service work: renewals, changes, client problems · 35 documents

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"I was just terminated: any advice? I just completed 3 years of service with LM. A year ago my department was dissolved and I moved into our choice department. I held my own pretty well for 6 months but this year they changed the metrics around, and as of today our 155 person strong department stands at 77. Well I was 77 now I guess 76. The goals got higher. The leads got tougher. I make no excuse, but all it took was falling into the bottom 20% once in my first few months, and second time in July, and finally a third time last month- my performance continued to degrade as the goals increased and my stress and feelings of ineptitude built up. I clocked in today and was terminated 10 minutes in. I was told to direct any questions to HR, who told me to direct questions about my 401k to fidelity, and my licenses are kind of in limbo no one seems to have any idea what happens with those. LM was my first broach into this field. It was the best money I ever made. But now I have a family, and I don't know what to do or where to go next- im not looking for job recommendations, I'm sure plenty of people already are. But what can I do to hit the ground rolling? How do I try to find a way back into an industry that just rejected my honest to God, best performance?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1fyelhw/i_was_just_terminated_any_advice/

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

AEP and enrollment season hours · 6 documents

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"Well this is where the studying comes in. In the first quarter you have OEP and in the rest of the year (ROY) you have various other enrollment periods and 10k people turning 65 every day. Lots of opportunities. But you have to learn to understand the system first. Your ability to sell is directly proportional to how well you can navigate Medicare and the various rules."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/ldlzz3/

"You blame Medicare marketing compliance rules for this.. You CANNOT say Medicare is ANYTHING like ACA. ACA will become like Medicare with *compliance and disclosures*. AND with our new admin(🍌🍌). We might not have ACA anymore. Just STM. Some of those short term medical plans are only for 3 months in some states even after the recent changes. And there are rules where you can't reinstate with some carrier in same year. Health insurance is a circus right now. Medicare(MAPD) and ACA are typically uneducated people getting harassed all day during AEP/Open Enrollment. The chronic flips thinking they're getting something *more everytime added*. If you want to talk about *deceitful* then look at limited med with multiplan without major medical carrier with it. Which is way less compliant than ACA. And they're discount plans not real insurance for 2-300\$+ Yes people click once or couple times. And those leads are sold and sold again every month(.20 cents - 50\$). And 90% of that business you could get from those cheap leads will be flipped by end of the year or within 3 months clawback time. Vs your 30% you're suppose to lose on avg every year. Call Amazon or some other large company right now and watch you get redirected from Customer Service to Medicare agency. Sometimes the smaller newer agencies do spoof the numbers or emails to look like local food business even Amazon. Everyone wants a piece of the pie"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npm451h/

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

Who they are (measured)

- 3,020 health / general agent documents; 77 life or final-expense agents on lead-buying threads; 40 new or aspiring agents. Every buyer tab prints its split.
- Stage (measured by source, not assumed): r/InsuranceAgent skews new and early-career agents asking what works; the agent Facebook groups and Insurance-Forums.com carry more working, independent Medicare / ACA agents.

What they believe

- Read of Tabs 5 and 6: most purchased leads are recycled, shared or not what was promised; the phone is the job; the money is in the book and the renewals, not the first commission.
- Read of Tab 5: MLM and captive agencies recruit on promises (156 documents), and CMS rules and carrier commission cuts can change the economics overnight (74).

The moment it changes

- AEP (Oct 15–Dec 7) and ACA OEP (Nov 1–Jan 15) — the lead-buying season; starting out after licensing; a lead vendor or FMO that stopped delivering; carriers cutting commissions for new enrollments.

What stops them

- Burned before by bad leads (125 documents; Dislikes: 34 leads that never answer).
- Cash: money spent on leads that did not pay back (23 fear documents).
- Compliance and chargeback exposure (7 fear documents; CMS recovers the full commission on changes in the first three months).

Where they are and how to reach them

- r/InsuranceAgent and r/InsuranceProfessional; agent Facebook groups (Insurance Agent Opportunities (USA); Medicare, ACA, & Life Agents and others); Insurance-Forums.com; agent YouTube (Cody Askins, Peter Roberts, David Duford, Medicare-agent channels).
- Meta reaches them with named-audience ads ('Medicare agents:', 'Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers!'); their own words for the product are 'exclusive', 'real-time', 'inbound calls', 'live transfers', 'aged leads', 'T65'.

Segments to write to

- Independent Medicare agents entering AEP with no pipeline (the AEP-urgency ads target them).
- ACA agents after the subsidy change who need fewer, better-qualified households.
- Agency owners buying for a floor (volume transfers, appointment programs).

Segments not to write to

- Brand-new agents with no lead budget (they ask for free leads; the MLM/captive recruiters own that segment).
- Property & casualty agents (different leads, different buyers; excluded by the voice gate).

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis from Tabs 4, 5 and 7: 'Consented to you, verified phone, never resold, replaced if bad' answers the complaints agents repeat most; the sellers already claiming it in ads show the market pays for it.

Buyer voices: agent 3,020 · agent life 77 · aspirant 40

Headlines

1. "If it's low stress and you're making that level of money, please stay." — Not making enough to stay in the business (39) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comment/s1rft8td/13_years_in_140kyr_need_advice/o7mlq53/
2. "Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems." — Money spent on leads that don't pay back (23) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_b

[e for you/](#)

3. "I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set." — Leads that answer and a phone that rings (68) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/
4. "Your goal is to build residual income." — A book of business and renewals that pay every year (24) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kmjoeg/whats_better_aca_or_medicare_sales/msbxwrl/
5. "On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life." — Friends and family pressure (the warm market) (46) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/
6. "So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan." — 'The money is in the renewals / your book' (15) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQJbtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoROzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq>
7. "Recently accepted a job with Globe Life" — MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises (156) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/
8. "Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e." — Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer (125) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/
9. "I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call." — Cold calling, door knocking and seminars (211) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/
10. "Independent agent looking for IMO with no requirements — just carrier access" — Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers (12) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_with_no/
11. "I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad." — Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job (9) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/
12. "Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online." — Six figures, or the month it finally worked (55) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/
13. "I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs." — A book of business paying renewals (14) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/
14. "We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials." — Dialing and the phone, all day (91) · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeee/
15. "Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride." — Service work: renewals, changes, client problems (35) · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

Frequency Ranking

#	Theme	Documents	Where
1	Bought leads from vendors	320	Tab 6
2	FMO / IMO lead programs	311	Lead source
3	Cold calling, door knocking and seminars	211	Tab 6
4	Referrals and their own book	208	Tab 6
5	Captive or call-center job first	204	Tab 6
6	Referrals and word of mouth	204	Lead source
7	Cold calling, door knocking, dialing	177	Lead source
8	Call centers / captive employers	167	Lead source
9	MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises	156	Tab 5
10	Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer	125	Tab 5
11	Seminars, events, workshops	124	Lead source
12	Live transfers and inbound calls (pay per call)	110	Lead source
13	FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs	106	Tab 6
14	Live transfers and inbound calls	104	Tab 6
15	Google ads / search / SEO	92	Lead source
16	Dialing and the phone, all day	91	Tab 9
17	Aged leads	86	Tab 6
18	FMO / upline lock-in and release fights	83	Private worry
19	CMS rules, commission caps and carrier cuts	74	Tab 5
20	Aged leads	73	Lead source
21	Named lead vendors (EverQuote, SmartFinancial, QuoteWizard, NextGen, Aged Lead Store, AllCalls...)	72	Lead source
22	T65 lists, direct mail, mailers	72	Lead source
23	Leads that answer and a phone that rings	68	Tab 2
24	Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing)	68	Tab 6
25	Compliance and carrier rules	56	Dislike
26	Six figures, or the month it finally worked	55	Tab 8
27	Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions	52	Private worry
28	Chargebacks and clawbacks	48	Dislike
29	Friends and family pressure (the warm market)	46	Tab 3
30	CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure	46	Private worry
31	Facebook / Meta ads (self-generated)	44	Lead source
32	Not making enough to stay in the business	39	Tab 1
33	Service work: renewals, changes, client problems	35	Tab 9
34	Leads that never answer or are fake	34	Dislike

35	Exclusive real-time leads	33	Lead source
36	Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies)	32	Tab 5
37	Money burned on leads that never answer	29	Private worry
38	Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions	28	Dislike
39	A book of business and renewals that pay every year	24	Tab 2
40	Money spent on leads that don't pay back	23	Tab 1
41	Clients who get angry when they are called	22	Tab 3
42	Booked appointments	22	Lead source
43	HealthSherpa / marketplace tools (ACA)	22	Lead source
44	A spouse and household riding on commission income	21	Tab 3
45	Shared real-time leads	21	Lead source
46	Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers	17	Tab 5
47	Not making money, no sales, broke in year one	17	Private worry
48	Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout	17	Private worry
49	Being tied to an agency, upline or contract	16	Tab 1
50	Uplines, managers and recruiters	16	Tab 3
51	'Don't buy leads, generate your own'	15	Tab 4
52	'The money is in the renewals / your book'	15	Tab 4
53	Six figures and the freedom that comes with it	14	Tab 2
54	A book of business paying renewals	14	Tab 8
55	Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers	12	Tab 7
56	FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release	11	Dislike
57	Carriers cutting commissions or pulling out	9	Tab 1
58	Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job	9	Tab 7
59	Dialing all day for a handful of conversations	8	Tab 5
60	Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented	8	Tab 7

Awareness → Offer Map

Unaware (new agent, no lead plan)

Hypothesis: 'What your first AEP costs in leads' — the math they ask for on r/InsuranceAgent.

Problem aware (burned by bad leads)

Hypothesis: name the burn in their words (old, shared, never answer) and show the replacement policy.

Solution aware (knows aged vs exclusive vs transfers)

Hypothesis: price per event next to what it produces (contact, appointment, enrollment) at their own close rate.

Product aware (compares vendors)

Hypothesis: the consent record, the phone verification and the exclusivity proof on screen.

Most aware (ready to buy for AEP)

Hypothesis: a capped AEP test order with a start date before October 15.

Silent Searches

What the independent Medicare / ACA / health insurance agent types, watches and is sold, measured side by side (typed = autocomplete that still names the worry; watched = YouTube videos whose title names it; spoke = own-voice documents; sold = ads to this audience).

Worry	Typed	Videos	Views	Spoke	Ads
Not making money, no sales, broke in year one	3	42	2,940,375	17	1
Money burned on leads that never answer	0	6	24,971	29	43
Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions	27	44	154,711	52	0
CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure	0	48	25,434	46	8
ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout	0	2	4,539	4	14
FMO / upline lock-in and release fights	0	54	138,446	83	21
Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout	7	41	725,860	17	5

Not making money, no sales, broke in year one

Typed: how to make money as an insurance agent · how to make money from insurance company · how to make money in insurance

Watched: Insurance BROKER vs. AGENT (Know the Difference) #agent #broker #insurance (963,974 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=va0c5svjhEQ> · How Much Money Insurance Agents Make (692,843 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzL0efcxQs> · How much money do you make? Insurance Broker (313,461 views) <https://>

www.youtube.com/watch?v=0Sy_Ce5T1nI · First Year Insurance Agent (217,292 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Eo9YVR1v1TQ> · How much do insurance agents ACTUALLY make? (199,602 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uq25B0E5KH0>

Money burned on leads that never answer

Watched: The Mistake Insurance Agents Make When Buying Leads ❌ #insurance #insuranceagent #sales #leads (20,057 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3EsCwn_jxPQ · Stop Buying Leads! How to Generate Your OWN Insurance Leads #shorts (4,298 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uKkWMt5O6kE> · Are Insurance Leads Worth The Money?? (324 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_DW3J3jXjE · The Truth About Insurance Lead Vendors (Avoid These Mistakes) (118 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J37FU9ZQVb4> · Are Veteran Leads Worth It? (Pros, Cons & What to Expect) (108 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k4rPoAWA5j8>

Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions

Typed: chargeback in insurance · chargeback insurance agent · chargeback insurance australia · chargeback insurance companies · chargeback insurance cost · chargeback insurance for businesses · chargeback insurance for merchants · chargeback insurance providers · chargeback insurance sales · chargeback insurance shopify · chargeback insurance stripe · chargeback meaning in insurance · chargeback on insurance · chargeback protection insurance · health insurance chargeback · how does chargeback insurance work · insurance chargeback commission · insurance chargeback meaning

Watched: What Is A CHARGEBACK? (38,779 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dqAr7wP_JqM · What Is a Chargeback? How to Dispute & Prevent Chargebacks in Your Business (17,010 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5ou8zEcFwRU> · What is the chargeback and chargeback process? #shorts #chargeback #process #guide #ecommerce #yt (15,983 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=51o33S28RtY> · Why Insurance Agents Get Chargebacks.. #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsuranceagent #sales (8,924 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UjNL031dguI> · Merchant Explains How To Fight Chargebacks (7,617 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5X5yIX6om24>

CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure

Watched: BREAKING: TCPA Update on New Cold Calling/Text Rules (6,723 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z47wv1_N41g · New CMS Rule Could Kill FMOs SGAs MGAs and GAs in the Medicare Market (2,176 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xzLS3fXxhng> · BREAKING: FCC Delays One to One Rule Change to 2026 ITCPA Update | Marketing Rules #realestate (1,907 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5bD7mgtTOWg> · Telephone Consumer Protection Act (TCPA) - How To Know If Your Rights Have Been Violated (1,382 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3T5-Q_iuBt4 · \$5 Million TCPA Lawsuit - Deryck Richardson Story 📺 (1,345 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=v7t5mMltOcY>

ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout

Watched: How to process Agent of Record (AOR) changes for ACA "Obamacare" policies!! (3,887 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iXCp-KwfmwY> · ACA Fraud, Agent-of-Record Theft & New Compliance Rules (652 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OuzM9NlbhIM>

FMO / upline lock-in and release fights

Watched: Insurance Brokers FMO and MGA (50,251 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HjL0fGqqz08> · Top 4 Lies FMO's Tell (30,117 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ubnhY5r3s8Q> · Which IMO / Insurance Company Should You Work For? (6,935 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9ZbNm21WRJs> · Use This TRICK to Get Released From Your Upline - Life Insurance Agent (6,168 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fQdVek4MTT8> · What The Hell Is An FMO? [And do insurance agents need one?] (5,162 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X8HgCWIK03Q>

Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout

Typed: why do insurance agents quit · why do life insurance agents quit · why do most insurance agents quit · why do most life insurance agents quit · why i quit being an insurance agent · why i quit being an insurance agent reddit · why i quit being an insurance agent singapore

Watched: WHY I QUIT BEING A REAL ESTATE AGENT! #realestateagent #realestate #business (528,797 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OnwPaRU5fO8> · Why I quit working for a State Farm Agent 🙄 (101,290 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MOjZYIzb4NU> · Why Do So Many Insurance Agents Quit? (16,821 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3Jki3D4Jok> · 102 Former Insurance Agents Explain Why They Quit [No BS] (15,195 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xv8pQ6cZ7oU> · Why Do New Insurance Agents Quit? [Cody Askins & David Duford] (11,184 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kjplGRoUJH8>

Private Worries

Measured absence: 0 first-person sentences say they keep something from their spouse, upline / FMO or clients.

Not making money, no sales, broke in year one · 17 documents

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"We do. But we also pay commission only since we are a younger agency. There are other agencies out there that would too. We buy 15-30 leads a day a producer. Warm leads. They average 30-40 calls a day, sell between 15-25k in premium a month. 3% ish close rate, quote about 10%. Not great, but every source we've tried sucks, this is the cheapest and the leads are decent."

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_liscence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p93nnh0/

Money burned on leads that never answer · 29 documents

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gy923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions · 52 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbggg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure · 46 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Be honest, how many of you are too hungry or greedy to actually care about your clients? Too often on this sub, I see posts full of frustration: "I can't close deals because customers are cheap." "The competition is undercutting me." "I need a new company with lower rates." Sound familiar? Complaining doesn't sell policies, and it certainly doesn't build trust with clients. What does work? Taking a step back and focusing on what you can control—helping people understand their risks and providing the guidance they need. Like Zig Ziglar and Jerry Acuff teach: "Help people get what they need, and you'll have all you need." Show, Don't Just Tell: Use Real-World Stories One of the best ways to help people understand the importance of proper coverage is by sharing real-life examples. Here's one: Imagine you're driving and accidentally hit a pedestrian—a 43-year-old father of three making \$90,000 a year. You only have \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage on your auto policy. Do you think \$100,000 goes far in this situation? Absolutely not. This man's medical bills could exceed \$500,000. He may lose his income while recovering, or worse, never return to work. The court won't just hold you responsible for his current medical costs—they'll look at his lifetime earning potential. That's millions of dollars. Now picture yourself on the stand in a courtroom. The plaintiff's attorney asks, "Why did you carry only \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage?" You respond, "Because that's all I could afford." (Which is a total lie) Then the attorney points out you're driving a \$60,000 vehicle with a \$600 monthly payment, yet you chose to skim on your liability coverage. How does that look to a judge? Conversely, you get a \$2000 vehicle with bad breaks or ball joints, hit the same pedestrian and not only will the judge be siding with the widow, if the judge finds out that you knew about the bad parts, you may be in for a manslaughter charge because of willful endangerment. Odds are, the widow will be awarded 40% of your pre-tax income until her children turn 18, then 20% for the rest of her life. I would tell the client that the 57 dollars a month in savings just cost you everything. This is why your job as an agent isn't just to sell policies—it's to help people manage their risks. Clients often don't understand the implications of their choices, and it's our responsibility to make those risks tangible. When we fail to explain the "why" behind higher limits, we're doing them a disservice. Here are other examples: A client with only \$150,000 in dwelling coverage on their home didn't realize rebuilding after a fire would cost \$244,000. They had to pay the difference out of pocket and face years of financial hardship. A business owner declined professional liability insurance, only to be sued for \$1 million after an employee error caused significant losses for a client. That lawsuit forced them into bankruptcy. Conversely, a family that opted for umbrella coverage was protected from losing their home after their teenage son caused a major accident. These stories aren't scare tactics; they're real-life scenarios. And they underscore the importance of listening to your clients, helping them understand their risks, and showing them why the right coverage matters. People don't want to feel "sold." They want someone who cares about their well-being and offers real solutions. Ask thoughtful questions. Share stories that make the risks relatable. Build trust by focusing on their needs—not your commission. When clients understand how proper coverage protects their family, their assets, and their peace of mind, they're more likely to say yes to higher limits. As agents, our job isn't just to provide a quote—it's to protect lives and livelihoods. Stop blaming external factors for lost sales. Instead, focus on what you can do better: Educate, advise, and build trust. Help your clients understand that managing their risks now can save them from life-altering consequences later. Let's stop complaining and start helping. Have any of you used similar real-life stories to educate clients? How did it work? Let's share ideas!"

— InsuranceAgent · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/

"Is this against AIL or Globe Life in general because I worked for the Liberty National division and if it's a class action lawsuit against globe, I would love to become a part of it."

— InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m75jzrt/

ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout · 4 documents

"If I contract, will I get fillable forms the consent forms? What about for recording? would not the CRM automatically record calls? I also need this recordings for Medicare as well I am probably going to buy if its workable depending on few other questions I gave you about leads What is voice consent with that just be the easiest way to do it?"

— YouTube · 🔥 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 🗨️ · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cLRWdaqypkc&lc=UgzFPjoJDBVsQUI7VN54AaABAq>

"ABC said: I called to speak with them and no one was available, I am really suspect since they are an Insurance Agency now. I don't think they are an insurance agency. I did some research and I think its a startup and they are running it out of their house. The owner has 2 jobs, check him out on Linked In. I want to know what happens a week later with the app. And a week after that with the feed to the carriers. I want something in writing that they aren't stealing my clients. (Which probably won't do any good, but it will make me feel better) For this year, I will probably use them on my webpage and also to send to people when I have run out of time. But not for people I am running the clients on via join.me"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Sherpa New Portal For Agents Working On the Exchange · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-sherpa-new-portal-for-agents-working-on-the-exchange.66461/#post-874324>

"Yes. I just had the first one terminated by the Marketplace for not sending in income verification documentation. This person is self employed; owns a flooring company. His adjusted gross income for 2014 was \$50,000. His taxes are with the tax accountant now. He is out of the country with no insurance. He does not know his income for 2015 yet. He thinks it may be higher. I called the Marketplace. They insist they have to have a bank statement; something. They said there was a discrepancy in his income. I was wondering how long it would take for this to begin? Now, I know."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971669>

FMO / upline lock-in and release fights · 83 documents

"Why i left the life insurance industry Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— LifeInsurance · 83 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1egggok/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout · 17 documents

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong.(never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you**. I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before 🍷, but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!"**

— InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fil2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Depending on what state you're in, we're in the middle of a lot of rate increase. Can't do much about it realistically but I took as much of that off of my CSR's as I could and did it myself (review/explanation/solutions). Do I feel burned out? Yea but my name is on the door and my CSRs haven't left and morale is good. We do what we can and don't get overwhelmed with things we can't control. Better for me to do the "tough" stuff than them IMO because I can't afford for them to get burned out and quit."

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gagmgg/23_years_in_this_business_and_ive_never_seen/nz6ed67/

Lead Sources

Source	Documents	Worked	Burned
FMO / IMO lead programs	311	8	5
Referrals and word of mouth	204	13	1
Cold calling, door knocking, dialing	177	5	7
Call centers / captive employers	167	9	3
Seminars, events, workshops	124	4	0
Live transfers and inbound calls (pay per call)	110	10	2
Google ads / search / SEO	92	2	2
Aged leads	73	7	3
Named lead vendors (EverQuote, SmartFinancial, QuoteWizard, NextGen, Aged Lead Store, AllCalls...)	72	7	4
T65 lists, direct mail, mailers	72	5	1
Facebook / Meta ads (self-generated)	44	2	0
Exclusive real-time leads	33	1	3
Booked appointments	22	0	0
HealthSherpa / marketplace tools (ACA)	22	0	0
Shared real-time leads	21	1	2

What agents say they pay, in their own sentences

- "I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/
- "Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/
- "So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth?" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/
- "I'm paid about \$250 per MAPD in my brokerage with no lead expense." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o7cpaf/medicare_agents_please_give_me_advice/njmo2ot/
- "It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/
- "I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/
- "Expensive live transfers at \$70 a call." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myqsmm0/

- "Discounted Facebook leads at \$10-\$15 a call." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yal_l_actually/myqsmm0/
- "I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/
- "I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront)." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/
- "Next you will say your cost per acquisition per item is just \$40 which is impossible with any lead gen program!" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jrvwh5/please_stop_taking_sales_roles_that_pay_4/ml64xe/
- "I've been at this for a few years now, and will admit I've been down the path of paying \$30-60+ per lead for "higher intent" leads and the ROI was never there." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myt04tg/
- "a company is offering me a 1099 position at \$200 per sale flat, selling medicare supplements following a script." · How To Make \$500k A Year As A Medicare Agent In 2023! (Medicare Sales Training) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmppgLPuqQ&lc=UgyD78lmlKn0yJUPmUp4AaABAg>
- "The old lead of yesterday getting .8 to 1% will be \$70 a lead soon ." · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/postage-going-up-another-7-4-legitimate-dm-has-a-few-yrs-left.115467/#post-1533168>
- "I pay \$54 weekly for unlimited leads but that comes out of my statement." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/krmx0ae/
- "The compensation plan for most agents is making ~\$90 per sale." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/kvcsv1e/
- "If you have good retention and QA you can make up to ~\$160 per sale." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/kvcsv1e/
- "Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/
- "Even if they got a killer deal at \$1 per lead that's 700-900 per day." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/nixjstfb/
- "We paid \$21-\$23 an hour and \$50 an app with the chance to earn more through accelerators." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o7cpaf/medicare_agents_please_give_me_advice/njn3u34/
- "\$55 a call is pricey when the calls never actually happened." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u9pr90/ringba_leads_through_i_integrity_connect_are_a_scam/
- "\$50 a lead." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qtg89e/rages_to_riches/o35st29/
- "I'm paying \$55 per lead, but even with that my CPA is sup \$40 for ACA plans." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nmfj8t/
- "I was paying close to \$85 per live transfer a few months ago." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l101rg/internet_lead_company_reviews_my_experience/mvvhk241/
- "Spent \$2000 on D-Snp leads & knocked on doors, went into Walmart & had a kiosk." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1h0xws/ywhich_insurance_sales_is_known_for_the_best/lzmzcbv/
- "I've heard of agents paying \$75-\$300 for leads, and that's not something that I am trying to do." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/mjp297q/
- "The last company I worked for (HealthMarkets) did exactly this and charged us \$36 per call we answered, mind you none of those calls turned to sales." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/nps166v/
- "I do this as well, i spend \$1500 a month on paid google leads." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4kwspj/
- "Then I read where people say they spend \$1400 a WEEK on leads on forums I visit....what world am I living in?" · r/InsuranceProfessional · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/yb73ad/>
- "I purchased a mix of live and slightly aged leads from a few vendors, paying \$50 per lead, but ended up wasting a lot of money." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lmbcnj/anything_is_possible/n10wio5/
- "I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/
- "I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/
- "I was told they pay \$25 a lead." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fx4zhe/i_hate_american_income_life_aill_so_bad/lqwd1f0/
- "We use to run Next Gen heavily around 2020-2022 before they started going down hill, we were paying \$1.80 per lead with them now we pay \$0.14c and the data is pretty solid, and there are more leads than we can buy essentially." · r/InsuranceAgent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/nogn0s1/>
- "I was buying so many leads a day I was paying \$2 a lead." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4qry22/
- "Your spend is under \$30 a day in these leads and you sell them?" · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4qry22/
- "Hi I know this was a year ago but there's a new young company recruiting Medicare sales agents, they say you'll get 30/40 inbound calls and work from home however they pay \$100 a sale." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/nasp1xsl/
- "Meaning if you pay \$6 a lead you're average CPA is \$600 lmao." · r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/ot306ij/
- "The old lead of yesterday getting .8 to 1% will be \$70 a lead soon ." · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/postage-going-up-another-7-4-legitimate-dm-has-a-few-yrs-left.115467/#post-1533161>
- "right about \$20/lead." · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=Ugzalu1C6ap0qrNtwUN4AaABAg>

Threads & Competitors

Group	Name	Documents	Positive	Negative
carriers	Humana	40	0	0
carriers	UnitedHealthcare / AARP	38	2	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	American Income Life / Globe	37	2	2
carriers	Blue Cross Blue Shield	30	0	0
carriers	Aetna / CVS	29	3	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Integrity	24	1	2
platforms & tools	HealthSherpa	22	0	0
lead vendors	SmartFinancial	20	1	1
platforms & tools	HealthCare.gov	20	0	2
carriers	Cigna	19	0	0
carriers	Wellcare / Centene / Ambetter	17	0	0
lead vendors	Caboom / Cody Askins	15	1	0
lead vendors	QuoteWizard / LendingTree	13	0	2
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Symmetry / Quility	13	0	0
carriers	Molina	11	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Ritter	11	4	1
platforms & tools	Medicare.gov Plan Finder	11	2	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Family First Life	10	1	1
brokers & call centers	SelectQuote	9	1	1
lead vendors	NextGen Leads	9	2	0
carriers	Kaiser	7	0	0
lead vendors	EverQuote	7	0	1
platforms & tools	SHIP counselors	7	1	0
carriers	Anthem / Elevance / Wellpoint	6	0	0
carriers	Mutual of Omaha	6	0	0
brokers & call centers	HealthMarkets	5	1	1
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	AmeriLife	4	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	Senior Life / Senior Choice	4	1	0
platforms & tools	GoHighLevel	4	1	0
brokers & call centers	Assurance IQ	3	0	0
lead vendors	Hometown Quotes	3	0	0
FMOs / IMOs / agencies	USHealth / USHA	3	0	0

Competitor Ads

Selling leads, live transfers, inbound calls and appointments to agents · 180 ads · 42 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities	3	687	none captured	Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! ❌ STOP Buying bad leads, direct mailing, & cold calling! ❌ STOP overpaying for leads and wasting money
Medicare Agents Hub	2	631	https://medicareagentshub.com/sign-up	Want More Medicare Clients? We've Got Them! - Appear in top search engine results . - Connect with seniors looking for Medicare help today . -
Cody E. Askins	15	361	https://info.caboomleads.com/	🚀 We help agents scale with PHONE-VERIFIED, qualified, compliant leads that convert. Every lead is CELL PHONE VERIFIED (via 6-digit security)
Seven Figure	3	262	http://sevenfigure.com/	📊 Building a stable Medicare book starts with the right prospects. Relying on recycled or unverified leads can lead to wasted time, lower ret
The Mason VanMeter	2	181	https://go.masonvanmeter.com/freereport	If you're buying insurance leads, you've already chosen the losing path — you just don't realize it yet. And once I explain this, you won't
FluxProtocol	5	158	https://fluxprotocol.ai/	If your ACA team is buried in follow-up, admin work, and recycled data, more lead volume will not fix it. FluxProtocol is built to reduce dr
profitprintercalls	2	156	instagram.com	Insurance agents — only 8% of you will make it past year one. You know why? It's not your pitch. It's not your product. It's not even your w
Blackrock Insurance Group	2	143	http://blackrockins.com/contact-us1	Insurance Agents What would your production look like if you had 10 to 30 inbound appointments every day? That is exactly what our system wa
Insurance by Stacy	3	133	https://stacygregoryinsurance.com/medicare-lead-system-for-agents	Medicare agents — tired of cold calling? You don't have a lead problem. You have a systems problem. I built a done-for-you Medicare lead sys
Break Free Agent	5	107	none captured	💡 🛑 INSURANCE AGENTS ONLY STOP relying on referrals. And please, stop wasting your money on aged and shared leads. Instead, start producing
Rick Love	1	94	https://texkingdom.com/agentmastery	I have been writing 300+ life insurance policies per year using an inbound lead system for more than 7 years now. (I still write this amount
Penguin Leads	10	80	https://penguinlead.com/	🚫 Stop Fighting Over The Same Leads . While every agent in America hammers the same Florida and California lists, smart agents are quietly clo
AllCalls.io	5	77	https://allinbounds.com/agentsV1/	Some Final Expense buyers see a commercial and call immediately. AllCalls.io routes those callers directly to your agents in real time. The
The Aegis Marketing	2	70	none captured	Final Expense agents — I'll send you seniors who are READY TO BUY . Pre-qualified live transfers, straight from my ads. No dialing.

Polycymatcher	6	65	app.polycymatcher.com	Agents: when's the last time a lead actually called YOU first? Not a recycled list. Not a cold dial. Not some shared lead 6 other agents alr
WeGenerate	6	64	https://www.wegeneratecalls.com/	Tired of bad Final Expense leads? We were too. That's why we mastered consumer initiated inbound calls. Aka... when interested customers cal
Senior Sphere Marketing	5	58	https://seniorsphereleads.com/	Want to write 15+ T65 apps per month — without chasing leads? We built a system that runs automated Medicare workshops for you... And turns th
Policylio	1	54	https://policylio.com/final-expense-calls	Stop chasing aged leads. Get exclusive Final Expense inbound calls from consumers actively looking for coverage. Our calls are delivered in
Medicare Client Flow	6	51	https://medicareclientflow.com/leadgen	If your agents are spending hours cold calling, buying outdated lead lists, or relying on inconsistent referrals... You're limiting your age
Nato Guajardo	3	44	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	If you're an insurance agent buying leads right now, you're probably paying \$25–\$50 for a lead that's being shared with 3 to 5 other agents.
Calls Flow	12	43	https://www.callsflow.io/	Medicare agents & agencies—AEP is coming. Get real-time inbound Medicare calls through CallsFlow. Sign up, top up, take calls, and close—no
zachbrsells with Penguin Leads	2	41	https://penguinlead.com/	You'll Think Of Every Excuse In The Book Until You Experience It Yourself And Put In The Work. You're Just A Lead List Away From The Life Yo
Advanced Agent Marketing	3	40	advancedagentmarketing.com	Annuity Producers – Start Paying for Appointments That SHOW (With \$250K-\$1M+ Ready to Move) That's exactly what annuity producers are gettin
Fidato Leads	2	36	https://www.fidatoleads.com/	Insurance Agents Stop paying for black box Insurance leads that eat your budget with zero accountability. At Fidato, we tag every single lea
Final Expense Leads Specialist	1	31	none captured	Final Expense Live Transfers – Save 10% Today! FB.ME Final Expense Live Transfers – Save 10% Today! Connect with high-intent Final Expense p
LeadStore	3	28	http://myleadstore.com/aep	Medicare agents and agencies — are you ready for AEP? Do you have people lined up to talk to, or are you walking into your busiest window ho
The Digital Insurance Agent	1	25	https://thedigitalinsuranceagent.com/leadgen	Our new client acquisition strategy that generates free IUL & Annuity appointments and how we've used it to increase our insurance agents co
Agent Lead Lab	1	22	https://lp.leadlabcrm.com/30k-optin-3x	If your lead source cannot confidently stand behind its product, why are you giving it more money? For qualified FFL agents doing \$30K+ per
SPRK	2	21	https://fex.sprktechnologies.com/home	Still spending your day calling Final Expense leads that don't answer? SPRK Final Expense Live Transfers put pre-screened prospects directly
Live Calls	1	17	none captured	Your agents shouldn't have to chase cold leads. Start receiving high-intent Medicare inbound calls from \$15.99 . We run nationwide Me
Keepsake Leads	1	13	https://www.keepsake-leads.com/	Fill your agents' day with pre-qualified inbound calls instead of a dialer. We send 20+ live inbound final expense calls a day, routed strai
GenTech Marketing	1	8	https://gentechmarketing.io/guaranteed-policies-page	Tired of your lead vendor re-selling the same insurance leads? 🤖 Our AI-powered branded appointment system is so predictable, we guarantee 3
Miguel Navarro Insurance Ads	1	8	https://www.skool.com/insuranceadslab/about	Comment "LEADS" and I'll send you my free 2-page guide on how to start generating your own insurance leads with Facebook & Instagram. You do
Medicare Growth Lab	1	7	none captured	Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers! ❌ STOP Buying bad leads, direct mailing, & cold calling! ❌ STOP overpaying for leads and wasting money
swaggerlifeleads	1	6	http://swaggerlifeleads.com/	🔥 LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS — STOCK UP ON LEADS! 🔥 Need more people to call? Swagger Life Leads has affordable life insurance leads available na
Medicare Lead Engine	3	6	http://www.medicareleadengine.com/	📢 AEP IS COMING. EVERYBODY'S ABOUT TO LOSE THEIR DAMN MINDS. Lead prices go up. Agents start fighting over prospects. Everybody suddenly nee
Daily Medicare Leads	1	4	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	AEP will break weak vendors. Not us. More calls. More pressure. More opportunities. → DML Platform, FREE. → 22+ platform features. → CRM — F
Inboundnd	3	4	none captured	Already buying Final Expense live transfers? Then you probably don't need another company explaining why inbound calls work. You already kno
Inboundcore.com	34	2	https://leadcore.life/watch	Done-for-you dialing for your agency. AI dialer, thousands of local numbers, area-code matching, fresh Final Expense leads every Monday. We
Medicare Masters	13	1	https://apply.medicaremasters.io/loom	Most Medicare agents don't have a closing problem. They have no predictable way to put genuinely new T65 prospects in front of themselves. F

FMO / IMO recruiting: contracts, 'free leads', ownership of your book · 89 ads · 33 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Preferred Senior Advisors	1	534	none captured	Are you stuck at a job you dislike? 🐼 Do you wish you had more schedule flexibility and higher compensation? Is there a lack of support at
Lifeline Family Benefits	1	291	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉 🏠 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule? 🏠 Work from your own home and take ad
Scaleyourlead	4	266	none captured	Insurance agents and agency owners: Running ads, managing leads, and following up shouldn't feel like a full-time job on top of selling. Som
SLD Solutions	1	263	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	You're licensed. Now your platform should match your level. What most licensed agents need isn't motivation — it's structure, consistent app
Equity Insurance Partners	1	242	www.instagram.com	Hard truth: captive agents don't build careers. They build someone else's company. It doesn't matter how good you are at selling. If your bo
USA Benefits Group	8	171	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-secara-berangsur-angsur/	📁 Ready to Earn More and Love What You Do? Join USA Benefits Group (USABG), an A+ rated national brokerage where licensed Health and Life In
Eterna Insurance Solutions	8	168	https://joineterna.com/	FINALLY a \$0 Program for Insurance Agents ⚡ Eterna Spark ⚡ - 70 Starting Comp Tier - \$0 Investment - Lead Flow Covered (inbound calls & re
InVida Elite	1	162	https://calendly.com/philipl-hudgins/30min-1	🔥 Join InVida Elite: Independent Insurance Agents Wanted! 📁 Are you ready to elevate your career with a company that values your independenc
Nick FitzGerald	2	159	none captured	📢 Texas Licensed Life Insurance Agents Let's be honest... If you're struggling right now, it's usually because of: ❌ weak training ❌ low contr
Selfless Financial	6	153	https://tierrebrowne.com/	Licensed insurance agents — watch how Tierre Browne's agents are building their pipelines. You'll see his mentorship process plus the Google

Monteith Group Financial & Insurance Services	2	140	https://go.themonteithgroup.com/ri	Just got your insurance license and not sure where to start? Our agents receive: ✅ Robust training to get them up to speed and producing ASA
Evan Schlang	2	128	https://evanschlang.com/annuity	If you're a licensed insurance agent and you're already producing, but you feel like you've hit a ceiling, this is for you. My name is Evan
Everything Senior Insurance	2	126	https://contracting.sevenfigure.com/	Medicare Agents 🚫 Are you tired of the same old lackluster & underwhelming experience you have with your FMO? It has almost become customary
Redbird Marketing	4	110	none captured	Now Onboarding Final-Expense Independent Insurance Agents. Contract directly with leading carriers. Top Commissions - Up to 125% first-year
Lasting Mark Agents	1	98	none captured	Are you tired of feeling like just another number in the insurance business? Even with years of experience, finding the right support can be
Retirement Realized Financial	1	98	https://retirementrealizedfinancial.com/	Annuity Agents: If you're happy making the same income year after year, if you don't want to learn new skills, or if you think your current
National Contracting Center	1	93	https://nccagent.com/contracting/	Your FMO should be giving you more than a contract. At NCC, we arm our agents with the tools, training, and resources to build a real busine
Family Life Insurance Group	1	65	none captured	Licensed life insurance agents: Stop spending your time chasing leads and start selling. FLIG provides the leads, multi-line dialing technol
Family Protected	1	60	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-sec-ara-berangsur-angsur/	👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉 👉 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule? 👉 Work from your own home and take ad
Carlos Roman	2	59	https://join.carlosromanofficial.com/roman-wealth-academy-en-	Licensed insurance agents are making \$10,000, \$15,000, even \$20,000 a month in this industry. So why aren't you? It's probably not your work
North Star Insurance Advisors, LLC	4	52	https://northstaria.com/remote-sales-agent/	You didn't get licensed to fund lead lists. North Star hands you inbound final expense leads all day. Bring the license — we bring the pipe!
Bankers Life - Brea CA	1	52	none captured	Licensed Life & Health Agents — Read This If you're tired of: • Chasing friends and family for sales • Paying thousands for "exclusive" lead
Gold Standard Coverage	14	51	none captured	Unlimited Final Expense Leads. Join our free agency webinar to see how our system works. Live Tuesday & Thursday at 7 PM ET. FB.ME Free Agen
P. F. Solutions	1	50	none captured	🚫 Licensed Life Insurance Agents Wanted 🚫 We're expanding our Final Expense division. When you contract with P. F. Solutions, you'll unlock
Advanced Agent Marketing	3	50	https://advancedagentmarketing.com/lp/application-fb	Annuity Producers – Start Paying for Appointments That SHOW (With \$250K-\$1M+ Ready to Move) That's exactly what annuity producers are gettin
Illuminate Virtual Team	1	45	none captured	👤 Life Insurance Agents: Work Smarter, Earn Faster, & Grow with a Winning Team 🌟 Tired of doing everything yourself and still falling short?
Insurance Advisors Direct	1	43	https://iadbrokerage.com/fmo-comparison/	Is your FMO helping you grow — or slowing you down? Download the free FMO Comparison Guide and see how IAD compares on carrier access, tools
Empower Brokerage Clients	1	38	https://www.empowerbrokerage.com/new-agent-licensing-spanish/	Are you stuck at a job you dislike? 🐼 Do you wish you had more schedule flexibility and higher compensation? Is there a lack of support at
LeadStore	1	28	http://myleadstore.com/aep	Medicare agency owners — do you have a system built to scale? Do you own your advertising? Do you own your book of business? Do you have som
AGA	1	28	https://appliedga.com/resource-aep-prep-success-kit/	Most licensed insurance agents go into AEP still fixing last year's problems. Accelerate 2026 is Applied General Agency's AEP kickoff event
Joshua Youngs - Medicare Machine Factory	1	16	https://medicarementors.com/career	🚀 Calling all Life and Health Agents! 🚀 Supercharge Your Success: Apply with Us TODAY 🚀 Quality Insurance Appointments 📞 Pre-Booked & Pre-Se
Catch Coverage	9	10	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-sec-ara-berangsur-angsur/	Catch Coverage is hiring licensed ACA agents. We hand you the inbound leads, training, and support. You bring your license and your talent.
Advocate Health Advisors	1	9	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-sec-ara-berangsur-angsur/	🌟 You're Invited: Medicare Business Growth Event. Join Advocate Health Advisors and EmblemHealth for an exclusive networking event created f

Software, AI, training and coaching sold to agents · 67 ads · 22 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
XCEL Solutions	4	330	xcel-solutions.com	XCEL makes it easy to get your P&C license with online and on-demand courses designed for busy learners. XCELSOLUTIONS.COM Study Your Way FI
Client Machines	2	217	none captured	Calling all Medicare agents! 🐼 Looking for some marketing tools that keep things simple for your prospects? How about whiteboard videos like
FluxProtocol	4	158	https://fluxprotocol.ai/	🚫 The ACA market is shifting. The old model of recycled contacts, spreadsheets, and phone-heavy follow-up is getting weaker. FluxProtocol is
PropHog	4	129	https://prphog.com/	WORK WITH LICENSED AGENTS ONLY! - Access NEW licensed insurance agents in any area of the country to expand your downline. Our mobile soluti
InsuranceSplash	6	116	https://websites.insurancesplash.com/v3	ATTENTION INSURANCE AGENTS Still stuck with an outdated website that makes your agency look small — or worse, no website at all? You're losi
Roomvu	1	95	https://www.roomvu.com/try-roomvu-mortgage	🚀 Attention Insurance Agents! 🏡 Grow your online presence, effortlessly! ✅ Get done-for-you social media content ✅ Attract clients with ease
Next Call Club	3	71	https://nextcallclub.com/insurance-lead-program-for-state-farm-agents	Insurance agents lose dozens of qualified leads every month because their number is flagged as spam before they even say hello. Book a free
Insurvoice.ai	2	66	https://us.insurvoice.ai/	Hiring and training insurance assistants is expensive and time-consuming. What if you could have a fully trained, compliance-ready AI assist
COACHG	2	64	https://coachgtraining.com/	The biggest misconception in Medicare is that top producers are simply more talented. They're not. They're operating inside better systems.
Dylan Saldivar	6	58	https://www.divinereach.pro/growyouragency	Insurance Agent Producers – This Little Known Recruiting System is the BEST Way to get committed agents to your downline in 2025.... [HERE'S
LifeButton AI	5	51	https://get.lifebutton.ai/webinar	🐼 Bye-bye paying for marked-up leads. Bye-bye paying retainers. 🐼 The truth? You don't need a marketing agency anymore. It's 2026. AI is tak
Advisor Learn	1	45	https://www.advisorlearn.io/strategy-session	Hey, this is Deepak here. I see that you've already taken a look at some of my training. So if you're still thinking about how to grow your

Canopy Connect	3	37	https://www.usecanopy.com/blog/top-challenges-of-insurance-data-intake	Insurance agency owners and producers, pull up your sent folder and search for the words "just following up." There's a decent chance you'll
Agent CRM: AI-Powered Sales+Marketing Software	8	26	http://medicare.agent-crm.com/	Most Medicare agents don't realize their CRM isn't HIPAA compliant — until it's a problem. Agent CRM was built specifically for Medicare age
Convoso	1	15	https://www.convoso.com/landing/voicemail/	Your calls are being blocked. That's why agents can't reach leads. Convoso helps you get calls answered—so more quotes turn into policies. S
My Bundle Pro	1	12	https://www.mybundlepro.com/	ATTENTION MEDICARE AGENTS You already sell the plan. Here's how to stop leaving the dental, the hospital indemnity, and the cancer plan on t
Axtion AI	5	10	https://axtion.ai/v2	Health Insurance Agents: Are the carriers throttling your business during peak OEP, or is your SMS provider secretly holding back your succe
Truly Insure	5	8	https://trulyinsure.com/start	Quick question for the insurance agency Owners It costs roughly \$3,000–\$5,500 to recruit one Final Expense agent once you factor in how many
InsuraCloud	1	8	http://insuracloud.ai/launchpad	Insurance agency owners: if 20 agents joined your agency next Monday, would they have everything they need to start producing—or would they
Casava Webservices	1	4	https://casava.app/insurance-agents	Insurance agency owners: every after-hours call you miss is a policy walking to a competitor. Casava builds you a website with an AI chatbot
Abraham Kevin Spann: Allstate Insurance	1	2	https://scalewithailive.com/scalewithai-theagent-stack-2026	Great producers. Strong pipeline. And still no clear view of what's actually happening inside the agency. That's not a sales problem. It's a
Abraham Kevin Spann - Certified AI Consultant	1	2	https://scalewithailive.com/scalewithai-theagent-stack-2026	Great producers. Strong pipeline. And still no clear view of what's actually happening inside the agency. That's not a sales problem. It's a

Captive and call-center jobs for licensed agents · 4 ads · 4 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
A&B Insurance, Inc.	1	121	https://aleragroup.zoom.us/webinar/register/5717174449382/WN_Mfj7a8S-T6Cr_aUIrNG05g#/registration	ATTENTION: Florida Health Insurance Agents! A&B Offering Sign on bonus for new agents joining the team. Both Inside sales and outside sales!
Your Advantage Group	1	35	none captured	We are hiring Independent 1099 Medicare Agents Your Advantage Group Must have an active Health Insurance License 2026 AHIP Certification pre
65 Pilot	1	29	https://65pilot.com/webinarregistration	JOB POSTING!! We're looking for someone who is dependable, coachable, organized, and genuinely enjoys helping people to join our growing Med
Indeed	1	1	https://www.indeed.com/q-full-time-jobs.html	Learn more about BroadPath. Now hiring Licensed Health Insurance Agents - Help. Explain. Enroll. WWW.INDEED.COM Apply Today Learn More

Other agent-facing ads · 16 ads · 10 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Senplicity	1	182	https://www.senplicityadvisors.com/ad-home	◆ FOR LICENSED AGENTS & AGENCIES ONLY ◆ Southern California Medicare agents - tired of paying for E&O and AHIP out of pocket? Most FMOs make
Insurance Agents & Brokers	4	127	https://www.iabforme.com/membership-application/	Join the premier network for independent insurance agencies across Pennsylvania, Maryland, and Delaware. Insurance Agents & Brokers (IA&B) c
Heartland National Life Insurance Company	1	121	none captured	Attention Annuity Producers! Discover Heartland National Life's new Fixed Indexed Annuity 🌐 Get the product details so you can confidently e
Ryan Egan	2	53	https://www.giveawaypad.com/100-quotes-per-month	100 P&C QUOTES — GUARANTEED OR YOUR MONEY BACK. Keep reading and I'll tell you: #1 How this works #2 Prove it works * How this works * A
Aegis Agency Solutions	1	44	none captured	For insurance agency owners doing \$500k+ a year in revenue. If you are relying on shared internet leads, exhausted call lists, or hiring mor
MESSER Financial Group	1	35	https://info.messerfinancial.com/get-info-2026-aep-prep-ads	The Medicare landscape has changed...do you have all the information you need? Messer is here to support our agents for AEP prep and beyond.
Deal Prediction	2	29	https://dealprediction.com/	Insurance Agency Owners — We will install a complete commercial appointment system inside your agency, and if your producers aren't sitting
Nick Berry	1	9	https://zakat.or.id/hikmah-turunnya-al-quran-sacara-berangsur-angsur/	Independent insurance agency owners: if you've spent money on Facebook ads that produced a few questionable leads and no clear idea what to
O'Reilly & Partners	2	4	https://oreillypartners.com/	Insurance Agency Owners — We will install a complete commercial client acquisition system inside your business, and if your team isn't booki
Quotely	1	3	none captured	For P&C Insurance agents investing in live transfers, internet leads and telemarketing Most agencies are paying an aggregator markup for cal

Dislikes

Complaint	Documents	1–2★ reviews
Compliance and carrier rules	56	2
Chargebacks and clawbacks	48	0
Leads that never answer or are fake	34	10
Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions	28	0
Shared leads sold to many agents	7	5
FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release	11	0
Captive and call-center jobs: quotas, pay, pressure	5	2
Lead debt and money burned	6	0

Compliance and carrier rules

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp....which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

Chargebacks and clawbacks

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks. And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

Leads that never answer or are fake

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are "a ton" of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill"**. From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects "yet"? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... thats because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they cant just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"For MAPD brokers, who is still writing UHC and Humana non-commissionable plans? Across most of the country over the past few years, UnitedHealthcare and Humana have made many of their MAPD plans non-commissionable. I refuse to work for free and represent these plans going forward. Are there any MAPD-certified brokers who are still willingly selling these plans? Just curious as to why you would put a client on a plan you receive no commissions on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1woc7yr/for_mapd_brokers_who_is_still_writing_uhc_and/

Shared leads sold to many agents

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaag95t/

"Former MGA here. I worked the TMK system (AIL Globe NILICO) for about 5 years and was VERY successful. So it is possible however I left and went independent for several reasons. 1. Everyone and anyone at AIL that talks about free leads vs paying for leads doesn't quite understand that they aren't comparing apples to apples here. Most leads at AIL aren't people who are looking FOR or interested in life insurance, the union leads are sort of close but they all think you're just coming to endorse the free AD&D. Most agencies these days aren't even running union leads anymore but running Will Kits Child Safe/mcgruff veterans etc. (my agency tested several other "kits" too like Cancer kits) Another thing is they recycle leads just as much as everyone else but they limit the amount you get and control when you get them. So yes they are free but imagine getting 60-100 leads and being told that's all you get for 60-90 days so you better collect referrals. (Heck you're trained NOT to say "insurance" on the phones 😂) 2. Starting at 50% comp these days is just silly when everyone else except WFG Primerica and PHP are starting new agents between 75-110% 3. The leaderboard is a liar, most (not all) of the people in the spotlight or whatever that magazine was called are not running the same leads that regular new agents are, they're running POS aka calling clients that purchased policies from different agents and then upselling them. Those that aren't are sometimes just chasing advance and doing shady things. 4. The rates for policies ESPECIALLY for people over 60 are laughable... example: I can get a 60 year old Male non tobacco user can get straight whole life NONE GRADED day 1 coverage (meaning the policy is issued and in force when you write it bc it's UW is electronic... no extra phone calls) 20,000 for 68.50 but since I don't like that specific carrier I'd get them a better policy or carrier with Mutual of Omaha for 84.32. Check the price on eapp for the difference and keep in mind... those prices aren't graded. Which brings me to number 5. It's hard to have residuals and renewals when your policies are being replaced. TLDR: It's a decent starter company and yes you CAN make good money but to all of us outside of it we look at AIL Prime WFG and PHP like middle schoolers trying to look cool wearing mom and dad's clothes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/jx47s9t/

"Some lead vendors are honest stating their leads are sold to multiple agents, others however claim their leads are exclusive while recycling and selling the same lead multiple times over. You can definitely still find prospects that have yet to purchase a policy or even some that you may be able to offer a better rate to, but for the most part this type of lead is garbage and a headache to deal with. My agency has been using Speakeasy Leads for almost a year now for final expense and general life insurance leads. Agent Advantage has also been great for IUL leads. Both seem to be the few that offer legitimately exclusive leads and I rarely get the "I've already spoken to 10 agents" bs lol. A few vendors I would avoid from previous personal experience: Integrity Lead Center - these leads are definitely resold to multiple agents Leadrilla - Garbage TTC Leads - They were great, but since their original owner past away the lead quality suffered Caboom Leads - Overpriced + prospects seem to be just shoppers MediaAlpha - I've received numerous leads in the past that had disconnected #'s paired with many prospects who have been deceased for years, overall just seems like fake data. Overall, the best method is to learn how to generate your own leads or hire an expert to setup your campaigns/lead capture funnels. This however is much easier said than done as it does take some time, effort and money to effectively learn paid ads, and if you do hire an individual or agency to manage this for you their fees are steep with no results guaranteed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merel99/

FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about AIL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, AIL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"So here's a funny twist in my insurance journey. I've been grinding, trying to build my agency, and for months I've been researching CRMs and dialers. I finally pulled the trigger and bought Ringy because everyone kept recommending it. Fast forward to this week... and I randomly discover I actually had access to Integrity's CRM, dialer, and lead marketplace the whole time for free through one of the agencies I'm contracted with. No one ever mentioned it. I literally stumbled into the dashboard by accident while looking for something else. Wild. I paid for a CRM meanwhile I already had access to one but my upline never brought it up. Smh Not mad about it though, just sharing in case any newer agents don't realize some FMOs/IMOs automatically give you tools like CRMs, dialers, quoting platforms, or lead systems that they never bother to highlight. Definitely worth double-checking what's included with your contracts before you go spending on extra software. If anyone else has had this happen or knows hidden features inside Integrity's system, drop some tips. I'm already finding stuff I didn't even know existed. However, I am going to keep the ringy platform. I really like the drip system they have for text and email and other features"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1odlyvq/solo_insurance_agent_looking_for_a_crm_dialer/no7I9a4/

"I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/nktnyr6/

Captive and call-center jobs: quotas, pay, pressure

"Do you know of any health insurance companies who pays their captive agent on an per hourly basis plus commissions? I just started with mine and its only 100% commission based, so for starters who dont have yet their clientele, money is a struggle. Do you have any advices?"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgzzDyeN1Egbxb-37nx4AaABAg>

"I can relate. As a captive agent I get lots of pressure to meet unrealistic sales quotas without any consideration for the quality of calls we are receiving etc. Hostile /cluelessly ignorant management just push harder for the dollar on the ones trying the most instead of boost the team and skill build. Top performing agents are the ones getting quality sale inbound directed to them on the backend through que assignment which I think is sus because it's clear those couple agents will continue doing big numbers while management whips us and acts like we should be able to do the same slam dunk on an outbound quote that was a no sale from the jump. There's some benefits working from home but yeah if the stress and money doesn't make sense it's confusing at times. But aye I worked hard to get where I'm at, ill continue to give my best - just not burn myself out because I've seen my enthusiasm and efforts be taken advantage of or unappreciated. Sometimes I wonder if I'm actually a licensed health insurance broker with a fiduciary responsibility or just a fkn used car salesman 🤔 cause God damn lol Hoping this week is much better tho for everyone here ❤️ "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bqgj6l/how_is_everyone_handling_burnout_during_these/kxeuukb/

"If you're building your own P&C book, why not go out and get appointed directly from the carrier? I'm a young P&C agency owner as well, and I've had my life license for about a year now (when I was with State Farm.) I never really liked life, but I know it builds solid retention within your book. So here in the next couple months I'll be looking out for life insurance company appointments. I'd rather sell life occasionally than be stuck working for an upline that mandates sales quotas and gives you crappy leads + takes a large chunk of your commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vtziac/my_experience_with_these_instagram_life_insurance/p54kywp/

Lead debt and money burned

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

Reviews by Star

NextGen Leads

- **1★** Disconnected or wrong numbers, unqualified leads, returns rejected or refunded at 10–12%, leads already in the agent's system (resold).
- **2–3★** Good technology and reps, poor lead quality; bidding on leads; mixed close rates (one sale from ~30 leads).
- **4–5★** Almost all name an account manager (Jeff, Madeleine, Jay); the few about leads praise first-access exclusivity if called fast.
- **What should change** A bad-lead return policy agents can trust, and proof a lead was not already sold elsewhere.

Allcalls.io

- **1★** Callers expecting a free 'food card', a 61-year-old billed as a Medicare call, a 26-second billing buffer, \$300 gone fast.
- **2–3★** Dropped calls, poor audio, refunds not received.
- **4–5★** Call clarity and the platform; one agency owner reports 2–4 policies a month per agent.
- **What should change** A longer billable-call buffer, age and intent screening before the transfer, refunds honored.

QuoteWizard

- **1★** Agents who bought: uninterested people and disconnected numbers; leads recognized from aged lists bought elsewhere.
- **2★** '\$15 a pop for fresh high-intent leads' that performed worse than aged leads.
- **4–5★** Mostly consumer reviews of the quote site, not agents (excluded from this tab's reading).
- **What should change** Freshness and exclusivity that can be verified.

SmartFinancial

- **1★** 'Don't buy leads from them'; a \$500 minimum deposit for about 40 leads that did not perform.
- **3★** 'Be aware of the billing and keep track of the leads.'
- **What should change** Transparent billing and credits.

Why They Buy

1. Why they buy

Leads are the business: without a pipeline there are no enrollments, and AEP / OEP compresses the year's income into a few weeks.

- Tab 6 · Bought leads from vendors · 320 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/
- "He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center." https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/
- Tab 2 · Leads that answer and a phone that rings · 68 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/
- "The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned " http://s://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/
- Tab 1 · Not making enough to stay in the business · 39 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rft8td/13_years_in_140kyr_need_advice/o7mlq53/

2. Recurring problems and frustrations

Old, fake, shared or unanswered leads; MLM and captive recruiting; bait-and-switch consumer marketing; CMS rules and carrier cuts.

- Tab 5 · Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer · 125 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8g9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertoengued/
- "This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads." https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/118sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/
- Tab 5 · Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies) · 32 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/
- "I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards." https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/
- Tab 5 · CMS rules, commission caps and carrier cuts · 74 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/
- "#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely." https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_t_commission_cuts/
- Dislikes · Leads that never answer or are fake · 34 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

3. Questions and objections that stop them

'Is this vendor legit?', 'Are the leads shared?', 'What's the replacement policy?', 'Will this get me a CMS or TCPA complaint?', 'Can I afford a lead budget before commissions pay?'

- Tab 7 · Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers · 12 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_w_ith_no/
- "I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training." https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/
- Tab 1 · Compliance, consent and losing contracts · 7 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencew_arning/
- "Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as" <http://s://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAq>
- Silent layer · Money burned on leads that never answer: 0 autocomplete phrases, 6 title-relevant videos, 24,971 views, 29 own-voice documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3EsCwn_jxPQ
- Silent layer · CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure: 0 autocomplete phrases, 48 title-relevant videos, 25,434 views, 46 own-voice documents https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z47wv1_N41g

4. Hooks and formats in the market

Measured over 356 agent-facing ads (153 video, 203 static): named-audience qualifiers, exclusive / verified / compliant claims, inbound calls with no dialing, income claims, attacks on junk and shared leads, guarantees.

- 93 ads · 35 advertisers use 'Named-audience qualifier ('Medicare agents:'); e.g. Lifeline Family Benefits: "👉 ATTENTION LIFE INSURANCE AGENTS 👉👉 Looking for the ability to work fully-remote control your schedule?" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=829459029996497>
- 93 ads · 35 advertisers use 'Named-audience qualifier ('Medicare agents:'); e.g. Scaleyourlead: "Insurance agents and agency owners: Running ads, managing leads, and following up shouldn't feel like a full-time job on top of selling." <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1804133846952126>
- 91 ads · 28 advertisers use 'Exclusive / verified / compliant leads', e.g. Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities: "Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers!" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674>
- 91 ads · 28 advertisers use 'Exclusive / verified / compliant leads', e.g. Cody E. Askins: "👉 We help agents scale with PHONE-VERIFIED, qualified, compliant leads that convert." <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=24607579135529462>
- 90 ads · 29 advertisers use 'Inbound calls / live transfers (no dialing)', e.g. Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities: "Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers!" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674>
- 90 ads · 29 advertisers use 'Inbound calls / live transfers (no dialing)', e.g. Eterna Insurance Solutions: "FINALLY a \$0 Program for Insurance Agents ⚡ Eterna Spark ⚡ - 70 Starting Comp Tier - \$0 Investment - Lead Flow Covered (inbound calls & re" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=836318702130873>
- 52 ads · 21 advertisers use 'Against junk / shared / aged leads', e.g. Exclusive T65 Medicare Opportunities: "Attention Medicare Agents & Brokers!" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1071008501391674>

- 52 ads · 21 advertisers use 'Against junk / shared / aged leads', e.g. Seven Figure: "🇮🇹 Building a stable Medicare book starts with the right prospects. Relying on recycled or unverified leads can lead to wasted time, lower ret" <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1410984154025601>

5. Features and benefits to demonstrate (hypotheses)

Consent to one agent — demonstrate it: the consent record with the agent's name. Verified phone — demonstrate it: the OTP step. Never resold — demonstrate it: exclusivity terms in writing. Bad-lead replacement — demonstrate it: the credit policy. Priced per event — demonstrate it: the per-transfer or per-held-appointment price next to the agent's break-even. Caveat: price reaction and vendor delivery are not measured.

- Tab 4 · 'Don't buy leads, generate your own' · 15 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/
- "I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads ." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAq>
- Tab 7 · Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented · 8 documents https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/
- "Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads?" <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwmm/leads/>

Metrics & Pricing

What an independent agent pays for each event on the way to an enrollment, what that event costs you to produce, and where to price it. Pick a lead type: its cost per lead and its four rates load together. Every rate is the median of the published figures listed under "Where every figure comes from", one vote per vendor (a vendor with several pages counts once, as their average); nearly all of them come from companies that sell leads, calls or dialing software, and the few agents who posted their own numbers are listed beside them. Raw = the lead price or media only. With labor = plus the calling it takes to reach, qualify and book (BLS wage, dialer speed, attempts per lead).

Market size

- **Medicare Advantage enrollees:** 35.2M — 55% of 64.2M with Parts A & B (KFF, Feb 2026)
- **ACA plan selections:** 23.1M — 2026 open enrollment, down 4.9% (CMS)
- **Max MA commission, 2027:** \$725 — New enrollment · \$363 renewal (CMS memo)
- **Enrollment window:** Oct 15–Dec 7 — Medicare AEP · ACA OEP Nov 1–Jan 15

No sourced count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found; the page does not estimate one.

Raw cost per event — by lead type

Bold = total for the needed count; the line under it = cost per event. Change any rate to use your own numbers; the lead type's cost per lead stays.

Calculator on the live page; the tables use the default lead type (Your own Meta lead form). Lead types (contact / appointment set / show / close of held %, cost per lead MA): Your own Meta lead form 47.5/17/75/20, \$22–\$37; Exclusive web lead (bought) 70/31.5/75/41, \$35–\$75; T65 exclusive (bought) 70/35/75/46.5, \$45–\$90; Shared web lead (bought) 25/19/75/21.5, \$15–\$31; Aged lead, 30–90 days (bought) 18.5/40/75/37.5, \$1.00–\$6.50; Live transfer / inbound call (bought) 100/100/100/25, \$58–\$109.

Funnel stage	Needed for 1 enrollment	Medicare Advantage	Medicare Supplement	ACA
Lead	82.6 leads	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$22–\$37 per lead)	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$22–\$37 per lead)	\$1,738–\$2,646 (\$21–\$32 per lead)
Contacted	39.2 contacts	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$46–\$78 per contact)	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$46–\$78 per contact)	\$1,738–\$2,646 (\$44–\$67 per contact)
Appointment booked	6.7 booked	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$273–\$459 per booked appointment)	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$273–\$459 per booked appointment)	\$1,738–\$2,646 (\$261–\$397 per booked appointment)
Appointment held	5.0 held	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$364–\$612 per held appointment)	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$364–\$612 per held appointment)	\$1,738–\$2,646 (\$348–\$529 per held appointment)
Enrollment	1.0 enrollment	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$1,820–\$3,059 per enrollment)	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$1,820–\$3,059 per enrollment)	\$1,738–\$2,646 (\$1,738–\$2,646 per enrollment)

Target enrollment budget

Model	Raw	With calling labor	Read
Medicare Advantage	\$1,820–\$3,059	\$2,203–\$3,442	Pays the agent up to \$725 now, \$363 a year after.
Medicare Supplement	\$1,820–\$3,059	\$2,203–\$3,442	≈\$502 first year (22% of a \$190/month Plan G); not CMS-capped.
ACA	\$1,738–\$2,646	\$2,121–\$3,029	\$20–\$30 per member per month while enrolled (BenaVest).
Agent buying live transfers (MA)	N/A	\$233–\$437	\$58–\$109 per call at the published median 25% close.
Agent buying exclusive leads (MA)	N/A	\$516–\$1,106	\$35–\$75 per lead at the published exclusive rates.

Cost per event with calling labor, and what agents pay

Funnel stage	Medicare Advantage	Medicare Supplement	ACA	What agents pay (market)
Lead	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$27–\$42 per lead)	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$27–\$42 per lead)	\$2,121–\$3,029 (\$26–\$37 per lead)	MA \$35–\$75 · Med Supp \$40–\$80 · ACA \$30–\$48 (the published price of this lead type (your Meta lead sells as exclusive))
Contacted	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$56–\$88 per contact)	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$56–\$88 per contact)	\$2,121–\$3,029 (\$54–\$77 per contact)	\$58–\$109 (MA live transfer / inbound call; Med Supp \$55–\$125; ACA \$32–\$90)
Appointment booked	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$330–\$516 per booked appointment)	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$330–\$516 per booked appointment)	\$2,121–\$3,029 (\$318–\$454 per booked appointment)	(No published vendor price for a Medicare or ACA appointment was found. One agency owner charges its own agents \$25 per presentation (r/InsuranceAgent (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1g6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/ny9dvtm/)) — an internal, at-cost price.)
Appointment held	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$441–\$688 per held appointment)	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$441–\$688 per held appointment)	\$2,121–\$3,029 (\$424–\$606 per held appointment)	\$212–\$454 (not a price: what a held MA appointment costs the agent now, buying exclusive leads at published rates (ACA \$181–\$290))
Enrollment	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$2,203–\$3,442 per enrollment)	\$2,203–\$3,442 (\$2,203–\$3,442 per enrollment)	\$2,121–\$3,029 (\$2,121–\$3,029 per enrollment)	\$233–\$437 (MA via transfers (\$58–\$109 ÷ 25% close); via exclusive leads \$516–\$1,106)

Lead types side by side (Medicare Advantage, published rates)

Lead type	Cost per lead (MA)	Contact	Appointment set	Show	Close (of held)	Lead → enrollment, these rates	Lead → enrollment, published	Cost per held appointment	Cost per enrollment
Your own Meta lead form (you produce)	\$22–\$37	47.5% (median of 3 sources (20–60%))	17% (median of 1 source (12–22%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	20% (median of 1 source (13.3–26.7%) — booked-basis figures + show)	1.2%	4–10% (2 published figures, median 5.8%)	\$364–\$612	\$1,820–\$3,059 (\$2,203–\$3,442 with calling labor)
Exclusive web lead (bought) (agents buy)	\$35–\$75	70% (median of 3 sources (40–85%))	31.5% (median of 3 sources (22–50%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	41% (median of 2 sources (25–50.7%) — booked-basis figures + show)	6.8%	7.7–25% (5 published figures, median 11.8%)	\$212–\$454	\$516–\$1,106 (\$602–\$1,192 with calling labor)
T65 exclusive (bought) (agents buy)	\$45–\$90	70% (median of 3 sources (40–85%) — exclusive figures)	35% (median of 1 source (30–40%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	46.5% (median of 1 source (40–53.3%) — booked-basis figures + show)	8.5%	(none published)	\$245–\$490	\$527–\$1,053 (\$2,289–\$4,313 with calling labor)
Shared web lead (bought) (agents buy)	\$15–\$31	25% (median of 5 sources (10–55%))	19% (median of 2 sources (10–22%))	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	21.5% (median of 1 source (13.3–29.3%) — booked-basis figures + show)	0.8%	1–12% (4 published figures, median 2.8%)	\$421–\$856	\$1,958–\$3,982 (\$2,289–\$4,313 with calling labor)
Aged lead, 30–90 days (bought) (agents buy)	\$1.00–\$6.50	18.5% (median of 2 sources (6–30%))	40% (median of 1 source (30–50%) — all lead types)	75% (median of 3 sources (60–80%) — all lead types)	37.5% (median of 1 source (25–50%) — all lead types)	2.1%	0.2–8% (7 published figures, median 2.8%)	\$18–\$117	\$48–\$312 (\$165–\$429 with calling labor)
Live transfer / inbound call (bought) (agents buy)	\$58–\$109	100% (median of 3 sources (95–100%))	100% (live call)	100% (live call)	25% (median of 11 sources (1–70%))	25.0%	1–70% (13 published figures, median 25.0%)	\$58–\$109	\$233–\$437 (\$233–\$437 with calling labor)

Read the two lead → enrollment columns together: for every lead type the published stage rates multiply to less than the published end-to-end figures. They come from different vendors, and the end-to-end figures often count applications or "closes" rather than effective enrollments. The truth for your leads sits between them until you measure it.

Your own Meta lead form

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$8.00–\$30 OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · \$10–\$40 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) · \$34 AdsUploader, Facebook CPL (WordStream / LocalIQ data) (<https://adsuploader.com/blog/facebook-lead-ads-cost-per-lead>) · \$88 ResultCalls, Medicare on Facebook (WordStream healthcare average) (<https://resultcalls.com/blog/how-to-get-medicare-leads-in-2026-using-facebook-ads>) → used \$22–\$37 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$8.00–\$30 OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · \$10–\$40 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) · \$34 AdsUploader, Facebook CPL (WordStream / LocalIQ data) (<https://adsuploader.com/blog/facebook-lead-ads-cost-per-lead>) · \$88 ResultCalls, Medicare on Facebook (WordStream healthcare average) (<https://resultcalls.com/blog/how-to-get-medicare-leads-in-2026-using-facebook-ads>) → used \$22–\$37 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$8.00–\$30 OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · \$34 AdsUploader, Facebook CPL (WordStream / LocalIQ data) (<https://adsuploader.com/blog/facebook-lead-ads-cost-per-lead>) → used \$21–\$32 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 35–60% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: FB setup 'gets you to 60% contact eventually' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qcyrm6/inbound_call_leads_for_struggling_life_insurance/nzsah6t/) · 20% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: Caboom (Facebook-generated final expense leads) '20% answer rate when called 10-15 times' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 12–22% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>)
- **Close:** 10–20% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 4% SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) · 5–10% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'Facebook leads - 5% to 10%' (good agents) (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mm0dceb/)
- Meta sources are not Medicare-only: OneLife's range covers all insurance lead ads, AdsUploader all industries, ResultCalls all healthcare advertisers.

Exclusive web lead (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$35–\$75 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$70 InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · \$35–\$75 InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) · \$20–\$40 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$25–\$80 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) → used \$35–\$75 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$40–\$80 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$40–\$80 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$22–\$48 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$45 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$30–\$80 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost>) → used \$30–\$48 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 70–85% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60–80% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 40–70% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 25–38% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 22% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 30–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)
- **Close:** 28–38% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onlifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held) · 25–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)

- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 8–15% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 10–15% InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · 8–15% InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · 10–25% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 7.7% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>)

T65 exclusive (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$45–\$90 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$45–\$90 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$45–\$90 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$45–\$90 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** no published price
- **Contact:** 70–85% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 60–80% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 40–70% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) (no figure for this lead type; all-lead-type figure used)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 30–40% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>)
- **Close:** 30–40% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- No T65-specific contact rate is published; the exclusive web-lead contact figures are used.

Shared web lead (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$12–\$26 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$18–\$35 InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) → used \$15–\$31 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$14–\$30 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$14–\$30 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$7.00–\$18 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$10–\$30 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) → used \$8.50–\$24 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 30–55% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 10–15% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 25% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · 10% Agent, Insurance-Forums: '20 shared leads and 10% pick up' (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-41297>) · 30% Agent, Insurance-Forums: '70% of all your shared leads won't answer' (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/looking-for-a-telemarketer-im-offering-2-0-00-a-week.2033/#post-27366>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 10–22% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) · 22% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>)
- **Close:** 10–22% OneLife, channel benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/insurance-marketing-benchmarks>) (of booked appointments; ÷ show rate to get of held)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<http://touchstonebpo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 2–5% InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) · 5–12% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 1% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · 2% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)

Aged lead, 30–90 days (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$0.50–\$3.00 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · \$0.75–\$5.00 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$8.00–\$20 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$1.00–\$10 OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) · \$1.00–\$8.00 Plura, live-transfer pricing (<https://www.plura.ai/articles/live-transfer-pricing-2026>) · \$0.01–\$0.50 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadwarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$1.00–\$5.00 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) → used \$1.00–\$6.50 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$0.50–\$3.00 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · \$0.75–\$5.00 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$8.00–\$20 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$1.00–\$10 OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) · \$1.00–\$8.00 Plura, live-transfer pricing (<https://www.plura.ai/articles/live-transfer-pricing-2026>) · \$0.01–\$0.50 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadwarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$1.00–\$5.00 SeniorCenterAgents, Med Supp leads (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-to-generate-medicare-supplement-leads-for-agents>) → used \$1.00–\$6.50 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$0.50–\$3.00 Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · \$0.50–\$3.50 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) · \$0.01–\$0.50 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadwarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$0.35–\$4.00 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$0.43–\$3.25 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 15–25% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · 6–12% OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · 15–30% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>)

- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 30–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) (no figure for this lead type; all-lead-type figure used)
- **Close:** 25–50% InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) (no figure for this lead type; all-lead-type figure used)
- **Show:** 75% SixtyFiveLeads, real cost of a lead (<https://sixtyfiveleads.com/post/real-cost-medicare-lead>) · 60–72% Touchstone, appointment-setting benchmarks (<https://touchstoneppo.com/blog/appointment-setting-conversion-rates-2026/>) · 70–80% Aexus, sales show rates (<https://aexus.com/what-is-a-good-show-rate-for-sales-appointments/>) (no source splits show rate by lead type)
- **Lead → enrollment, published:** 1–3% AllCalls, inbound Medicare calls (<https://allcalls.io/blog/is-real-time-medicare-inbound-calls-worth-it-2026-cost-benefits-and-verdict/>) · 2–5% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 2–5% InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · 2–8% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 0.2% The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · 3–7% Aged Lead Store, health lead prices (<https://agedleadstore.com/health-insurance-leads-cost/>) · 0.8% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: '0.8% conversion rate on 30 day+ leads' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu3qz9h/)
- OneLife publishes contact by age band (7–30 days 15–25%, 60–120 days 6–12%); both bands are used for 30–90 days. No aged-specific appointment or close rate is published, so the all-lead-type figures are used.

Live transfer / inbound call (bought)

- **Cost per lead, Medicare Advantage:** \$45–\$120 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$125 InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · \$40–\$120 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$45–\$85 InsureLeads, Medicare lead companies (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/best-medicare-lead-companies>) · \$45–\$85 InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · \$90 AllCalls, inbound Medicare calls (<https://allcalls.io/blog/is-real-time-medicare-inbound-calls-worth-it-2026-cost-benefits-and-verdict/>) → used \$58–\$109 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, Medicare Supplement:** \$55–\$125 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) → used \$55–\$125 (median low – median high)
- **Cost per lead, ACA:** \$32–\$85 OneLife, 2026 lead prices (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/blog/insurance-lead-costs-2026>) · \$30–\$90 The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · \$100 InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>) → used \$32–\$90 (median low – median high)
- **Contact:** 95–100% Plura, live-transfer pricing (<https://www.plura.ai/articles/live-transfer-pricing-2026>) · 100% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 100% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>)
- **Appointment set (of contacted):** 100% — the transfer is already a live conversation.
- **Close:** 15–25% AllCalls, inbound Medicare calls (<https://allcalls.io/blog/is-real-time-medicare-inbound-calls-worth-it-2026-cost-benefits-and-verdict/>) · 15–25% InsureLeads, conversion benchmarks (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-lead-conversion-rate-benchmarks>) · 15–30% InsureLeads, Medicare leads (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/medicare-leads>) · 15–25% InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) · 20–30% The Leads Warehouse, Medicare & ACA prices (<https://theleadswarehouse.com/how-much-do-medicare-and-aca-leads-cost-in-2026/>) · 25–40% OneLife, Medicare benchmarks (<https://onelifemarketingsolutions.com/medicare-lead-generation-statistics>) · 20–40% SeniorCenterAgents, lead costs (<https://seniorcenteragents.com/blog/how-much-do-insurance-leads-cost-for-independent-agents>) · 25% Agent, Insurance-Forums: 'brokers are closing 25% of the live calls' (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vemo-leads.3125/#post-19367>) · 20% Agent, Insurance-Forums: 'closing 1 in 5' live calls (<https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-41307>) · 40% Agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'I close 40% of the inbound calls' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/jvpu80t/) · 60–70% Agent (ACA), r/InsuranceAgent: 'I close 60-70% of my calls' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nmfoj8t/) · 1–2% Health-agency marketer, r/InsuranceAgent: paid inbound calls at a 'consistent 1-2% close rate' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ge3mjw/if_you_use_paid_marketing_can_you_share_your_stats/) · 15–20% Agent reply, same thread: telesales 'if inbound they should convert at 15-20%'; outbound 5-10% of total leads (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ge3mjw/if_you_use_paid_marketing_can_you_share_your_stats/lu6vxjq/)
- A transfer is already a live conversation, so the appointment and show steps are 100%; 'cost per lead' is the price per call.

Agent-reported, lead type not stated (context only, not used in any median)

- Agent reply, same thread: telesales 'if inbound they should convert at 15-20%'; outbound 5-10% of total leads (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ge3mjw/if_you_use_paid_marketing_can_you_share_your_stats/lu6vxjq/); outbound telesales 5–10% of total leads; face to face 25–35%.
- ACA agent, r/InsuranceAgent: 'burned through about 10–15k with maybe a 5% close rate' (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okb93m/how_a_bad_aca_enrollment_hit_my_family_and_why_i/).
- **Vendors contradict themselves:** InsureLeads prices 30–90-day aged Medicare leads at \$8–\$20 on InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) and \$0.75–\$5 on InsureLeads, cost per lead (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/insurance-leads-cost-per-lead>), and exclusive Medicare leads at \$20–\$40, \$35–\$75 and \$70 on three pages; each vendor counts once, as the average of its pages.
- **Cited but not found in the original (not used):** InsureLeads, how much Medicare leads cost (<https://www.getinsureleads.com/blog/how-much-do-medicare-leads-cost>) cites a "LIMRA 2025 Insurance Distribution Study" (new agents close 9.2% of exclusive web leads, 1.8% of shared, 12.1% of transfers) and a "2025 NAHU survey"; neither figure appears in anything LIMRA or NABIP (NAHU's name since 2022) publishes publicly.
- LeadsBridge, Medicare Facebook leads (<https://leadsbridge.com/blog/medicare-facebook-leads/>): Meta instant forms about 20% lower cost per qualified lead than website forms (a 2023 study it cites); no rate or price.
- Agent posts with numbers on health lines were scarce: 2,428 r/InsuranceAgent and r/InsuranceProfessional records pulled on 2026-09-26 for rate threads; most figures posted were for auto / home or life.

Calling labor

- \$17 median hourly wage, telemarketers (BLS OEWS May 2025, telemarketers (<https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ocwage.t01.htm>)) ÷ 70% wages share of employer cost (BLS Employer Costs for Employee Compensation, June 2026 (<https://www.bls.gov/news.release/ecoc.nr0.htm>)) = \$24 per hour.
- 80 dials per hour on a power dialer (Call Logic, power dialer (<https://www.calllogic.com/power-dialer/>)): 60–100; 7 attempts per lead (Kadence, contact-rate benchmarks (Astoria Company research) (<https://www.startkadence.com/glossary/what-is-contact-rate-insurance-leads/>)): 6–8).
- Talk time per reached lead: 13 minutes exclusive / T65 / your Meta form, 4 minutes shared / aged (OneLife: 8–18 minutes exclusive, 2–6 shared). Bought transfers carry no dialing.

- Not included: dialer / CRM / SMS software (\$150–\$400 a month, InsureLeads), consent certificates, management.

What an enrollment is worth to the agent

Metric	Benchmark	Implication
Medicare Advantage	\$725 new · \$363 renewal (CMS CY2027 FMV, national; CA/NJ \$902, CT/PA/DC \$816)	The ceiling on what any MA lead is worth; renewals roughly double it over three years.
Part D (PDP)	\$130 new · \$65 renewal	Too small to carry a paid lead on its own.
Medicare Supplement	≈\$502 first year (22% average commission (Pinnacle; 14–27% range, Essential Care) × Plan G at 65, median of \$165 / \$190 / \$220 a month)	Carrier-set, not CMS-capped.
ACA	\$20–\$30 PMPM (per member, per month enrolled (BenaVest; Ritter example \$20))	A household of three for a year ≈ \$720–\$1,080; lapses stop it.
Chargebacks	Full within 3 months (any plan change in the first three months; pro-rated after)	A lead that enrolls and switches costs the agent the whole commission — buyers will ask how you screen.

How to price each event

Uses the lead type and rates above. Price = the middle of your cost with calling labor × 1.3, rounded up to \$5, kept inside what agents pay and at or below the agent's three-year break-even (first-year commission plus two renewal years at half). The appointment "market" is the agent's current cost per held appointment, because no appointment price is published.

Product	Your cost with labor	Agent first-year break-even	What agents pay	Your price	Your margin per event
Medicare Advantage · Lead (sold exclusive, or at this lead type's price)	\$27–\$42	\$8.78 (3-yr with renewals: \$18)	\$35–\$75	\$20 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$22 to –\$6.69
Medicare Advantage · Live transfer (a reached lead who agrees to talk now)	\$330–\$516	\$181 (3-yr with renewals: \$363)	\$58–\$109	\$110 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$406 to –\$220
Medicare Advantage · Held appointment	\$441–\$688	\$145 (3-yr with renewals: \$290)	\$212–\$454	\$290 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$398 to –\$151
ACA · Lead (sold exclusive, or at this lead type's price)	\$26–\$37	\$3.63 (3-yr with renewals: \$7.27)	\$30–\$48	\$10 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$27 to –\$16
ACA · Live transfer (a reached lead who agrees to talk now)	\$318–\$454	\$75 (3-yr with renewals: \$150)	\$32–\$90	\$90 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$364 to –\$228
ACA · Held appointment	\$424–\$606	\$60 (3-yr with renewals: \$120)	\$181–\$290	\$120 (Loses money even at the low cost)	–\$486 to –\$304

Decision read

- **Cost per MA enrollment by lead type (published rates, before labor):** aged \$48–\$312, transfers \$233–\$437, exclusive \$516–\$1,106, T65 \$527–\$1,053, your Meta form \$1,820–\$3,059, shared \$1,958–\$3,982. The agent earns \$725 in year one; your Meta form and shared cost more than that even at the low price.
- **A Meta-form lead is worth an exclusive price only if it converts like one:** at the published Meta rates (47.5% contact, 17% set, 20% close) it produces 1.2% enrollments, worth \$8.78 to an agent in first-year commission, against the \$35–\$75 exclusive price, which assumes 6.8%. Measure your first leads' contact and set rates before quoting a price; the published end-to-end figures for Meta leads (4–10%) are higher than the published stage rates multiply to.
- **Aged records worked into held appointments is the one production route that clears the market at published rates:** \$62–\$161 per held MA appointment with calling labor, against \$212–\$454 an agent pays for one through exclusive leads; priced at \$215 the margin is \$54 to \$153. As transfers: \$46–\$121 against \$58–\$109 paid per call. Caveat: no aged-specific appointment or close rate is published; the all-lead-type figures are used, so test it.
- **Transfers are the agents' cheapest purchased route after aged data:** \$233–\$437 per enrollment at the published median 25% close. Producing them from Meta forms costs \$330–\$516 each at published rates, so a transfer business runs on inbound call ads or aged data, not on forms.
- **AEP moves price, not value:** OneLife reports 20–45% price inflation on Medicare leads during AEP; since January 2025 insurance ads on Meta cannot target by age (financial special ad category).
- **Treat every rate as a vendor claim until you measure your own:** almost all published figures come from companies selling the leads; the agents who posted numbers report lower contact on shared and aged leads and transfer close rates from 20% to 70%.

Market and commission sources: CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo (<https://www.psmbrokerage.com/hubfs/Agent%20Broker%20Compensation%20Memo%20CY2027.pdf>) · 42 CFR 422.2274 (chargebacks) (<https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-42/chapter-IV/subchapter-B/part-422/subpart-V/section-422.2274>) · KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026 (<https://www.kff.org/medicare/medicare-advantage-in-2026-enrollment-update-and-key-trends/>) · CMS, 2026 open enrollment (<https://www.cms.gov/newsroom/press-releases/exchange-coverage-remains-near-record-high-23-1-million-enroll-2026-reflecting-continued-strength>) · BenaVest, ACA commissions (<https://www.benavest.com/aca-commissions-for-agents/>) · Ritter, ACA agent earnings (<https://ritterim.com/blog/how-much-can-agents-make-selling-under-65-insurance/>) · Pinnacle, Med Supp commissions (<https://pfsinsurance.com/blog/medicare-supplement-commissions>) · Essential Care, commission structures (<https://essentialcareagents.com/blog/medicare-broker-commission-structures-ma-pdp-med-suppl/>) · MoneyGeek, Medigap cost 2026 (<https://www.moneygeek.com/insurance/health/medicare-supplement-plans-cost/>) · MedicareSupplement.com, cost by age (<https://www.medicare-supplement.com/articles/average-cost-of-medicare-supplement-by-age/>) · The Senior List, Medigap cost (<https://www.theseniorlist.com/medigap/cost/>) · PSM Brokerage, Meta special ad category (<https://www.psmbrokerage.com/blog/navigating-meta-ads-restrictions-for-insurance-agent-s>). Pricing is a recommendation built on these inputs, not a measured market price.

Sources, Method & Gaps

One corpus and one voice router (hi_voice.py) for the three pages; every document carries exactly one voice.

Precision reads

- Voice router (hi_voice.py), hand-read of 15 random documents per voice after five rounds of rules: Medicare shopper 13/15, family helper 12/15, agent 12/15, life / final-expense agent 11/15, ACA shopper 12/15 (was 10/15 before the personal-detail rule), aspirant 9/15 before the last fix (licensing advice from working agents; rule tightened, not re-sampled).
- Agent-facing ads: the full list read by hand once (67 page overrides with a reason each), then a fresh random 30: audience 30/30 agent-facing, seller type 27/30 with the three misses pinned.

- Themes: frame and object in the same sentence; broad objects that counted any mention (a spouse, a phone, a video) were moved to framed themes after reading the capture lists; themes under five documents are dropped, not padded.
- Metrics tab: the page JS and the Python model agree on 252 priced fields across six input sets (0 mismatches).

What was not pulled, and why

- Facebook agent groups: the group feeds did not load for the research account (member-only groups, throttled feed pages), so only 17 publicly indexed posts were read with their comments (20 agent documents). A warmed account that joins the groups would add the largest missing agent source.
- Insurance-Forums.com: the first page of each thread only (up to ~10 posts), from the Senior Insurance, Health Insurance Exchange, Insurance Leads, Final Expense and Health Care Reform subforums.
- No count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found in a citable source; the pages do not estimate one.
- TrustPilot pages were pulled per star level, so star counts are a reading sample; several vendors have no TrustPilot page (Inboundcore, Digital Senior Benefits, Integrity, Ritter, HealthSherpa). BBB was not pulled.
- Meta Ad Library: active US ads on quoted phrases only, no spend or impressions for US commercial ads; Meta's own policy page blocked the scripted fetch, so the special-ad-category rule is cited from PSM Brokerage and Data-Axle.
- Vince's feed: none yet (no agent-facing ads seen), so every advertiser comes from the Library search.
- Quora (403), LinkedIn (not logged in) and BiggerPockets were not read.

Tool status (D0)

- 2026-09-25: Tavily 968 of 1,000 monthly credits already used, so Facebook discovery went through web search restricted to facebook.com instead; Apify: three fresh accounts (\$5 each) used for consumer Reddit (harshmaur~reddit-scraper, calibrated at ~\$0.002 per record; ~\$12.40 spent in total including one duplicate test run aborted at \$0.87); YouTube Data API: ~9,900 of 10,000 daily units; SerpAPI not used; research Chrome (CDP 18800) for Reddit agent subs, Facebook permalinks, TrustPilot and Insurance-Forums.com (relaunched once after a CDP timeout); Ad Library read headless and logged out.

Sources

- CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo, June 1, 2026 (psmbrokerage.com copy)
- 42 CFR 422.2274 (eCFR) — compensation recovery / chargebacks
- KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026: Enrollment Update
- CMS press release, 23.1 million enroll in 2026
- KFF, What we know about 2026 ACA marketplace enrollment
- Vendor and FMO benchmark pages: OneLife Marketing Solutions (2026 lead prices, Medicare benchmarks, channel benchmarks), SixtyFiveLeads, InsureLeads, AllCalls, Plura AI, Aged Lead Store, Quotely, Lead Distro AI, HyperTarget, Ritter, BenaVest, Pandora — flagged as vendor-sourced on the Metrics tab